

NATURAL LEADERSHIP: A CORE COMPETENCY OF CLARITY

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One moment at a time,
One relationship at a time,
Always for the benefit of all

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*Every forest branch moves differently in the breeze,
but as they sway, they connect at the roots.*

~ Rumi

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What is Natural Leadership?

Imagine being a leader in your company who operates with clarity, ease and authenticity as your partners. Imagine generating extraordinary results without drama and constant conflict. Imagine knowing moment to moment that your team is aligned and synergistic and working with a shared vision of success ... that is Natural Leadership.

You already are a successful leader or you wouldn't be reading this. Already you have learned quite a bit. Yet, you are not always able to take what you know and use it in difficult situations. You are really good at what you do. Yet, because of the extreme complexity of our times, we need to rely on clarity as our core competency for success. We see ground-breaking and innovative developments in connectivity and technology, business methodologies, personal awareness and change paradigms day by day. Without clarity, authenticity and a good sense of humour, we will most likely be behind the curve as late adaptors rather than the leaders during these times.

Natural Leadership is the ability we are all born with to do the right thing. When informed by clarity, we have a true sense of our natural ethics, and our authority. We know that these abilities infuse the fabric of our lives.

We also need extraordinary business skills, emotional intelligence, and the personal disciplines of Natural Leadership.

As we gain confidence in the clarity of our vision, opportunities for Natural Leadership are more available and accessible. As we gain confidence in our decision-making in this paradigm, the critical leadership skills of clarity-based intelligence emerge. This fosters instinctive confidence that leads to superior performance with high effectiveness and efficiency.

We empower our employees and those around us to trust their natural authority, to thrive in their skills and talents and become Natural Leaders. You, your employees, customers, vendors, shareholders, and family immediately experience benefit from being with you.



Purpose, Vision, Mission and Guiding Principles

We all have a *purpose*, our reason for being born. Living it creates immense joy and freedom. Some of us remember our purpose and some do not. When we were children, we had a connection with our purpose. It was as natural to us as breathing. It served as a backdrop of the games we played, the books we read, the people we were drawn to, the dreams we had and the feelings and thoughts that seemed to come out of nowhere. Many of us lose that connection; some of us may not even remember we had it. Regardless, without it, it doesn't matter how much money and power we accumulate, most of us are conscious of something missing, an ache, a loneliness and we will create crisis after crisis in an effort to find the missing piece.

A *vision* is a picture of our purpose brought to life. As we evolve through education, and life experiences, we re-find our purpose, we bring our purpose to life with a vision that helps us navigate our life experiences. We create a *mission* that supports our day-to-day life. This gives us a natural foundation and meaning we need to make a difference for the benefit of all.

If we live our vision, what will be the result? For example, we may want to help people. Our vision is a safe world for all. Our mission is the way we personally live our vision, for instance by becoming a firefighter. We do our best to insure people's safety when there are fires. We fulfill our mission of helping people and work toward our vision of a safe world. There are an infinite number of ways to fulfill the vision of a safe world. And as you might expect, we express this through our individual unique conditioning. Yet, just by being alive, we can all share a common vision, purpose and mission, such as "for the benefit of all." This *Guidebook* will make that clear.

To forge a direct pathway to clarity, we need to look at our beliefs about the world and ourselves. Beliefs are what we unquestionably think is true. Much of this "truth" is stored in each cell of our body-mind. Many of us don't even notice or think about what we believe and how this affects our decision-making.

When our purpose, vision and mission inform our decisions, life works. If we live our vision informed by clarity, integrity and responsibility, we are inspired to grow no matter how we feel. We are focused on the big picture, rather than the moment-by-moment situation.

Regardless of the environment where we as leaders are headed – corporate, non-profit, public or community service – responsible action informed by clarity and the vision of the organization, creates an irresistible magnetism to draw the resources, people and events necessary for us to accomplish our goals.

Guiding principles are how we live our purpose, vision and mission. Guiding principles are fundamental truths that serve as rules and agreements that govern our personal behavior. They are the source and basis for the success of living our purpose, vision and mission.

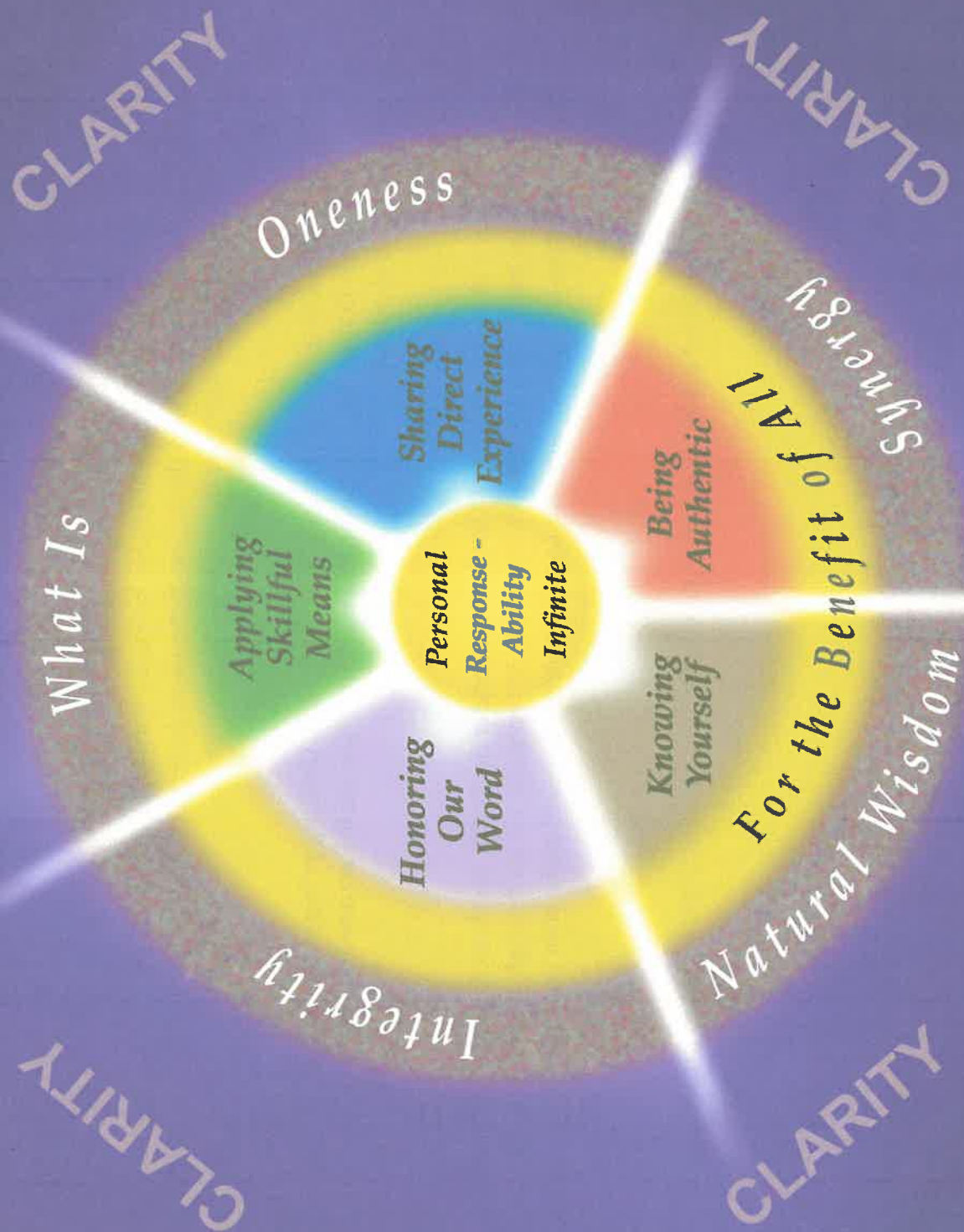
The Natural Leadership: A Core Competency of Clarity is an “under the hood” methodology that has evolved through the participation of many organizations over the last 30 years. As we go through this process together, please make sure you address all your considerations and concerns. We will make sure your questions are answered completely.

A Natural Leader is someone who understands the responsibility that comes with clarity and freedom.

~ Judith Orloff, M.Ed.



NATURAL LEADERSHIP: A CORE COMPETENCY OF CLARITY

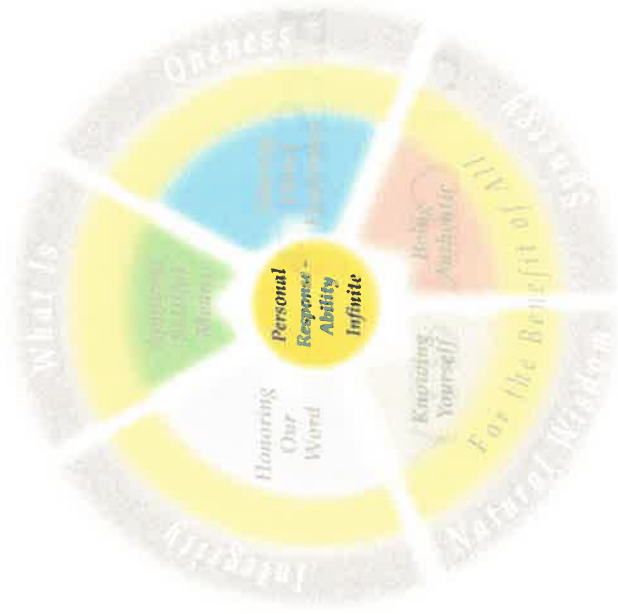


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Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #1 – Personal Responsibility

Being personally responsible (response-able) means mastering the ability to respond to each situation, each moment, with unlimited options, always for the benefit of all.

Personal Response-Ability



Being Accountable for Results

We know we are the source of our experience and our life. We grow with the ability to be responsible for how we feel, think and behave. We know we are the author and owner of the results we have created in our life.

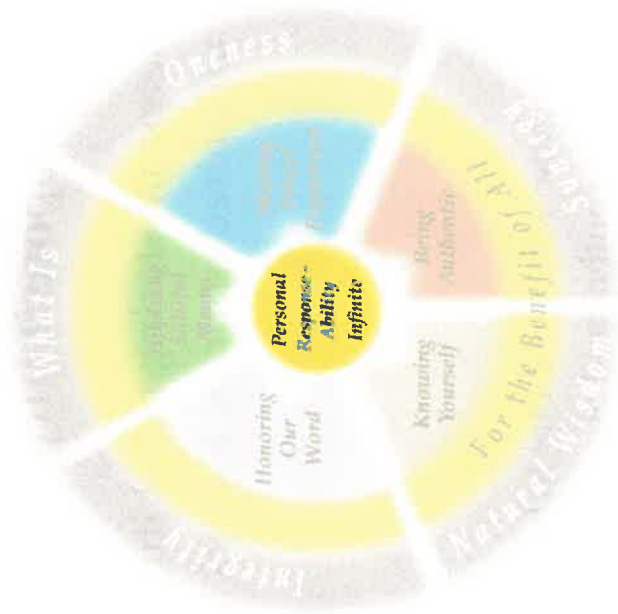
BENEFITS:

Being the source of our life journey
Personal evolution and transformation

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Notes and Reflections



Personal Response-Ability



Allowing Many Alternatives

In an environment of clarity and personal response-ability, participation from everyone is natural. All want to share and be connected with the community they are part of at any time. Accessing our direct experience with each other allows for solutions that include everyone's gifts and talents.

BENEFITS:

Being open to whatever arises in clarity
Natural collaboration and synergy



Notes and Reflections



Personal Response-Ability



Congruence: Transparency and Harmony

When we are congruent, our thoughts, feelings and actions are aligned. Congruence allows everyone to respond, always for the benefit of all. There is no separation between inside and outside. We have one face.

BENEFITS:

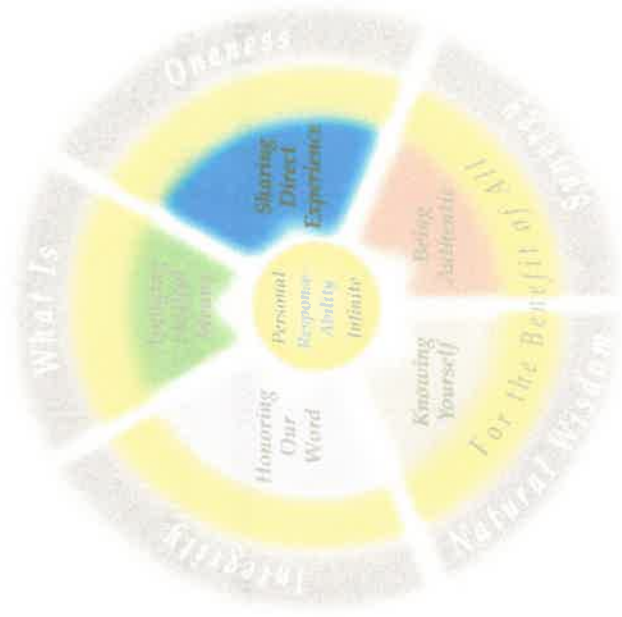
- Ease of connection
- Trusting relationships
- Alignment within and without

The result in mastering the competency of Personal Responsibility is trust in life itself

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Guiding Principle #2 – Sharing Direct Experience

Honesty about our experience, informed by clarity is what allows for transformation. Giving and receiving feedback with “good purpose” means sharing your direct experience with nothing added or withheld. This is a direct path into clarity and feelings of connection.

Sharing Direct Experience



Listening and Receiving

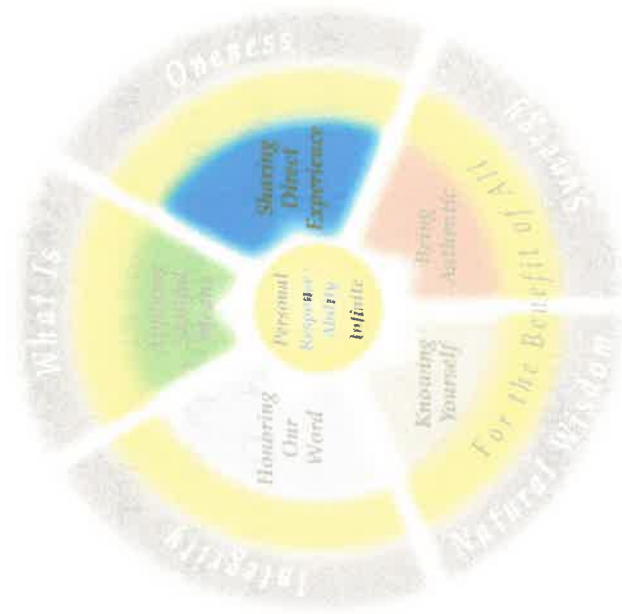
Our direct experience is that which is true in us, about us, in the moment without interpretation, right here, right now. When we share our direct experience, it cannot be argued with – it is just about ourselves! We don't defend, take care of, manipulate, blame or continue to make our point. Black and white, right and wrong are no longer our perspective; rather, different perspectives become openings for intimate conversation.

BENEFITS:

- Open-hearted communication
- Natural intimacy
- Experience of oneness



Notes and Reflections



Sharing Direct Experience



Opportunity for Transformation

The open-hearted understanding that is the result of Radically Listening to another transforms our personal experience of ourselves. Willingness to receive what others are giving us is critical for transformation. When we feel threatened, we need to remember that what feels threatened cannot be real.

BENEFITS:

Vulnerability
Natural learning

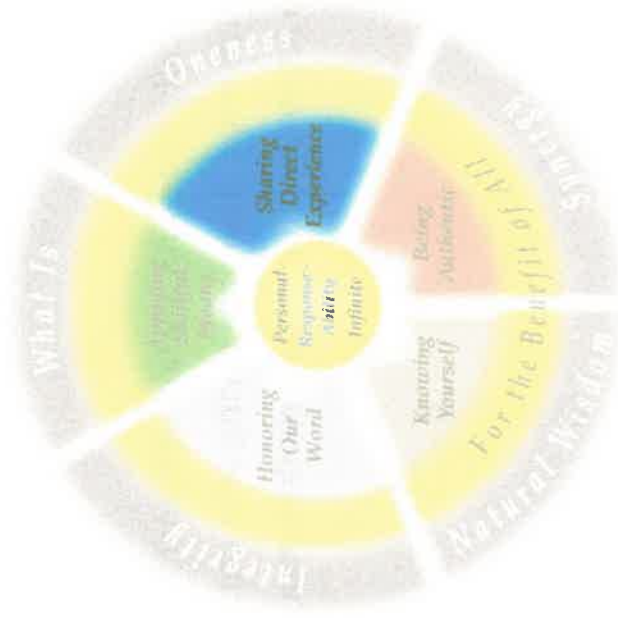
The only source of knowledge is experience.

~ Einstein

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Sharing Direct Experience



Without Defense, Justification or Explanation

It is unnecessary to search for the root cause of our successes, failures and mistakes. When we defend, justify or explain, we strengthen our points of view and lose sight of "what is" right here and now. We can share what is true for us and just move on without leaving a trace. We need not worry about how we appear when we share our direct experience.

BENEFITS:

Natural affinity and partnership

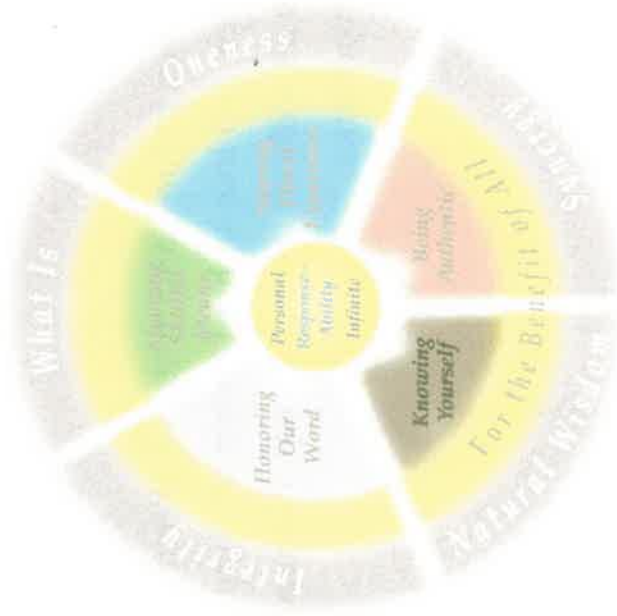
Right and wrong dissolve into natural ethics

The result of mastering the competency of Sharing our Direct Experience is oneness

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Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #3 – Knowing Yourself

Knowing our self and our points of view allows us to walk in the world without fear of loss and the need to control our environment.

Knowing Yourself

Understanding Our True Nature

Our true nature is clarity. Other names for clarity can be unconditional love, Buddha mind, God and non-dual awareness. Just spend time with a small child and watch how life moves through them without self-consciousness. As we grow up, we tend to lose the wisdom we had as a small child. Instead, we rely more on our conditioning. We believe our points of view are who we are, and we want others to share our beliefs and values. We often argue for our perspective to be the right one. Relaxing our points of view allows us to see “into clarity” and experience our true nature.

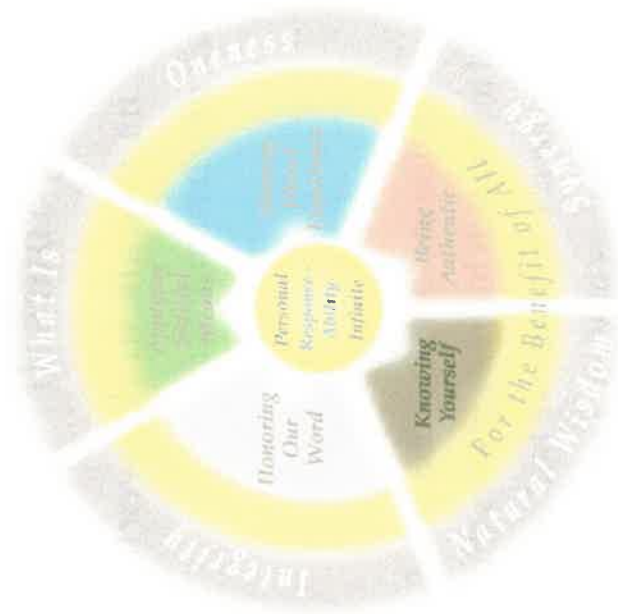
BENEFIT:

Reliance on clarity for everyday life situations

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Knowing Yourself



Assuming Innocence

Every adult was once a child and was innocent. Assuming innocence in motivation is a challenging competency to live by. Even though a particular perspective may be incomprehensible to us, it is not to the other person. By assuming innocence in everyday situations, we are not bound to any particular response. Our solutions are comprehensive and arise from a natural intelligence and are for the benefit of all.

BENEFITS:

Trusting your direct experience

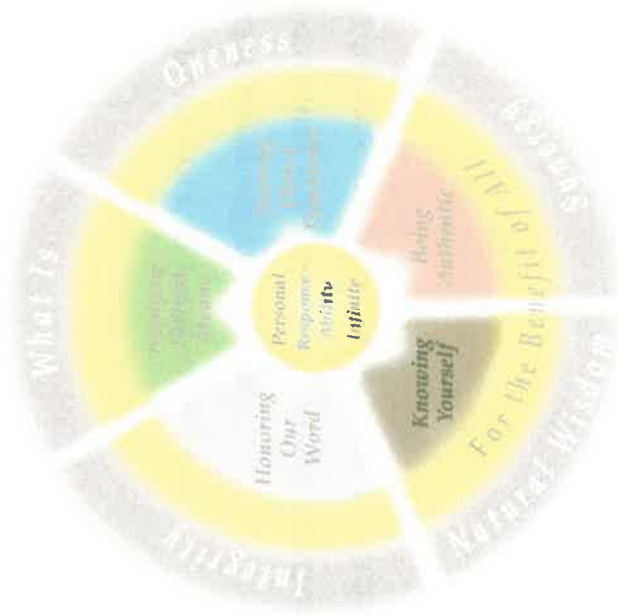
Acceptance of "what is"

Choosing from infinite possibilities

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Knowing Yourself

Uniting Our Personal Vision with a Larger Perspective, for the Benefit of All

Although we are all equal, we are also unique. We have natural gifts and talents that are part of our uniqueness. Everyone is unique, no one is special. When we live and work together, we can evolve and transform so that we move closer to our vision, and our mission can be lived more effectively.

BENEFIT:

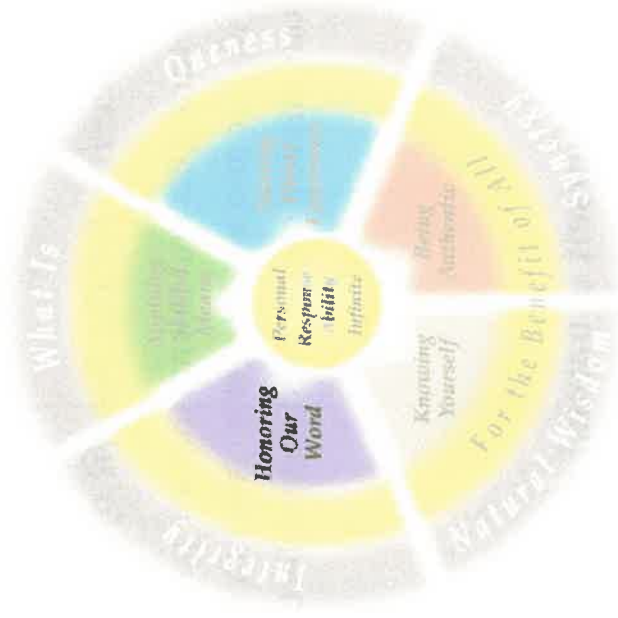
Vision and mission are large enough for all to participate equally

The result in mastering the competency of Knowing Yourself is natural wisdom, natural authority and natural ethics

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Guiding Principle #4 – Honoring Our Word

Honor and keep our word.

Honoring Our Word



Keeping Our Word

Keeping our word is simply doing what we say. If we are not accountable to our word, we are not in integrity. Our lives cannot work in ways that bring us satisfaction and joy.

BENEFITS:

Integrity

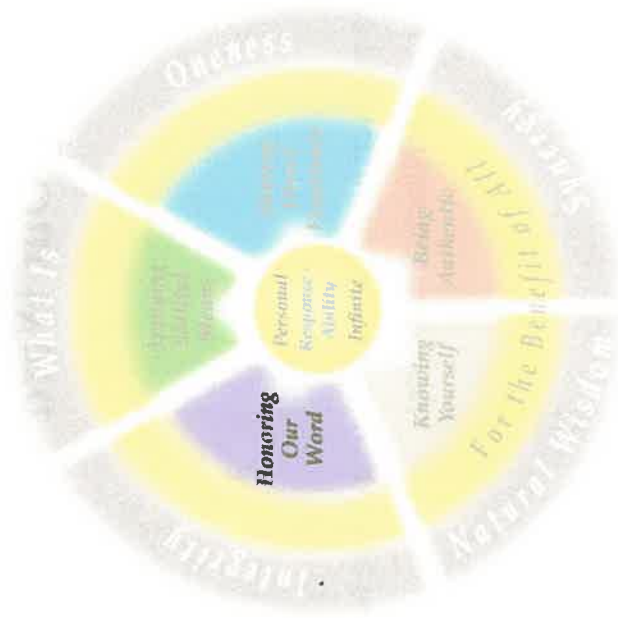
The state of being complete and whole

Strengthened connection to life

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Notes and Reflections



Honoring our Word



Timely Communication

Although keeping our word is fundamental to happiness and contentment, we will not always be able to do so, especially as we grow in our influence and Natural Leadership. Life presents situations that call for our attention. As soon as we become aware that we are unable to keep our word, it is important to communicate this and to make sure all involved feel whole. When communication is timely we are “honoring our word.” This can only be positive.

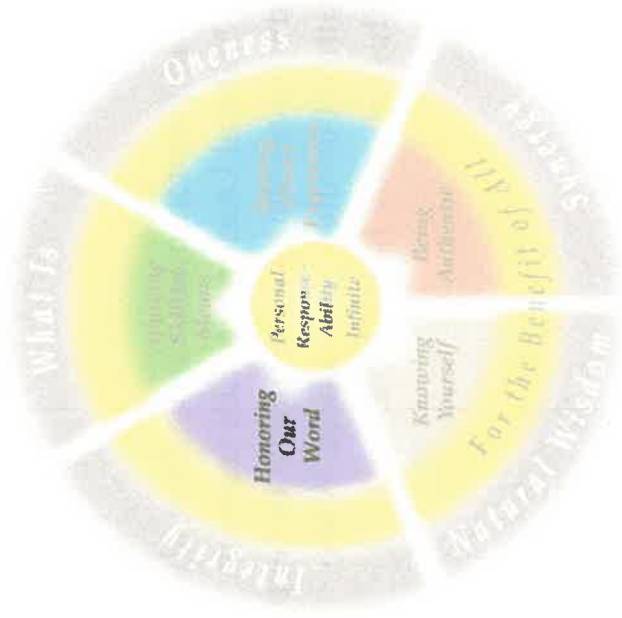
BENEFITS:

- Respect-infused relationships
- Everyday fulfillment
- Care-free life experience

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Notes and Reflections



Honoring our Word



Free Choice

A Free Choice is one made after authentic consideration of benefit and without situational conditions. Before making a Free Choice it is important to consider all options, experience all points of view and remember that all perspectives are equal and connected. Our personal vision and mission can lead the way in determining our Free Choice.

BENEFITS:

Decisions informed by clarity

Consideration of all points of view, options and suggestions

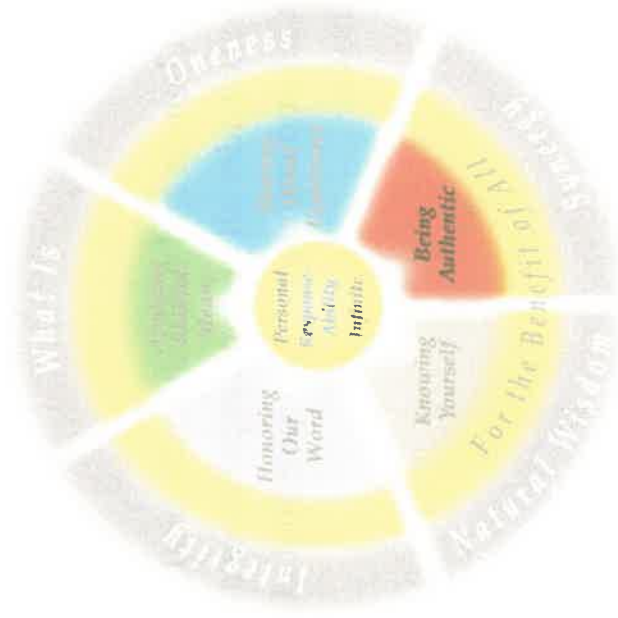
Knowing that all perspectives are equal and connected

The result in mastering the competency of Honoring Our Word is integrity

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Guiding Principle #5 – Being Authentic

Authenticity is undisputed credibility and genuineness. We view ourselves and others as equal. Although we have unique roles and responsibilities, we are equal beings.

Being Authentic



Communicating What Is True without Pretense

We are true to our character and spirit, no matter what the situation or environment. With authenticity as our natural way of being, we have access to knowing who we are and can live for the benefit of all.

BENEFITS:

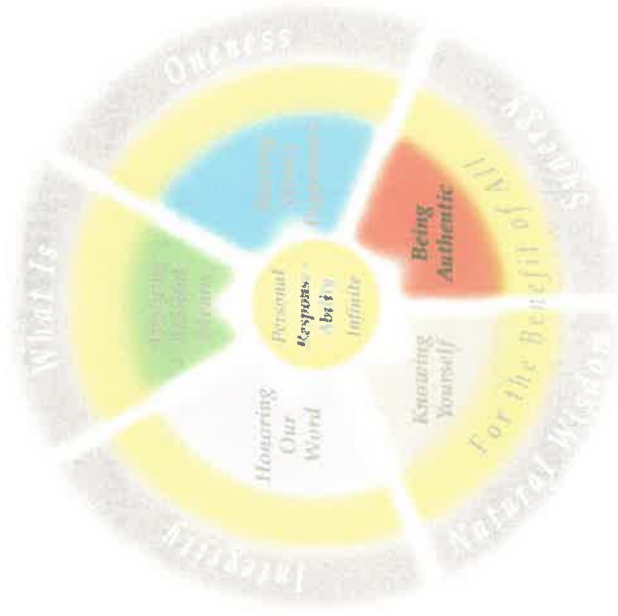
Embodiment of clarity and oneness

Feeling good about ourselves

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Being Authentic



Embodying Trust and Equality

From a Natural Leadership perspective we create the experience of trust and equality by embodiment of these qualities. Trust is complete reliance on the integrity, natural authority and clarity of oneself. Equality is the capability for each of us to use our natural gifts and talents to live a joyful life.

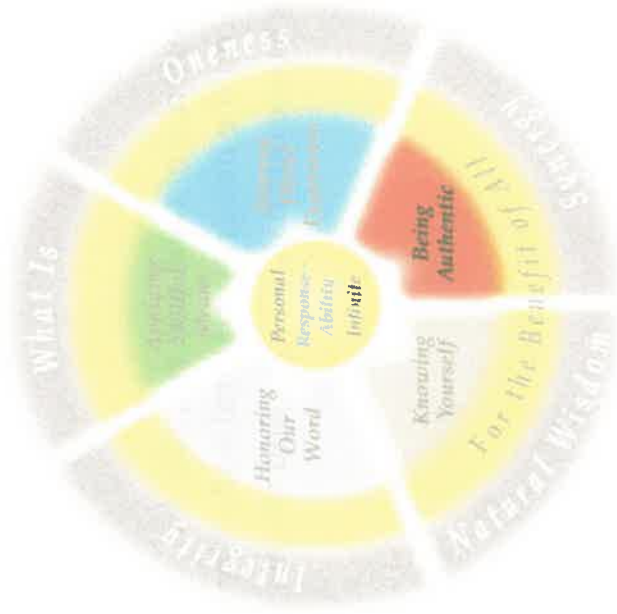
BENEFIT:

Naturally healthy life style

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Being Authentic



Awareness of Intention before Taking Action

By relying on clarity we see our intention each time we act. Sometimes it moves by very quickly and we catch it by noticing the response we receive. With practice, we naturally become aware of our moment-by-moment intention and our actions become consistent with our vision and mission.

BENEFITS:

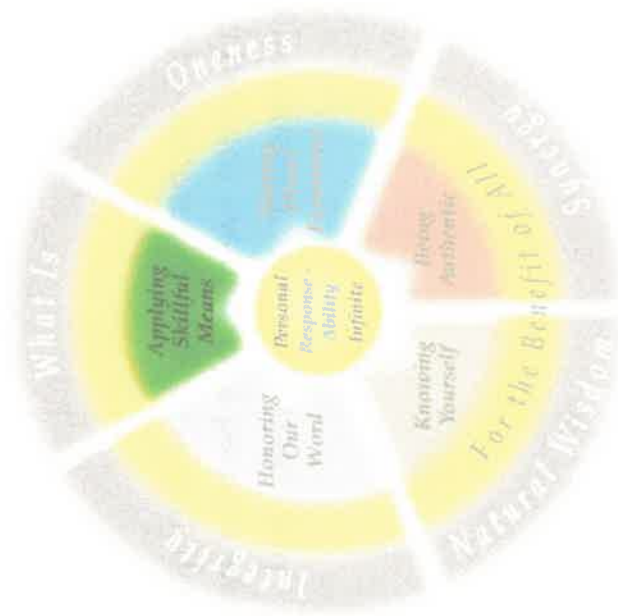
Fear and doubt disappear
Uniqueness and interdependence move as one
Synergy

The result in mastering the competency of Being Authentic is synergy

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Guiding Principle #6 – Applying Skillful Means

Using Skillful Means allows us to know what actions to take in all situations. Skillful Means point to truth, and are extremely flexible and contradictory. Only when we are relying on clarity can we use Skillful Means. Each situation is unique and each person is unique. Clarity points us to what makes sense in each moment with each situation. Natural Leaders choose their Means to suit the individual or group they are leading.

Applying Skillful Means



Seeing through Our Reactions

As we thin our reactions, we grow our capability to look beyond any particular behavior to the open space of clarity. We can now approach any situation with compassion. We rely on clarity to use Skillful Means.

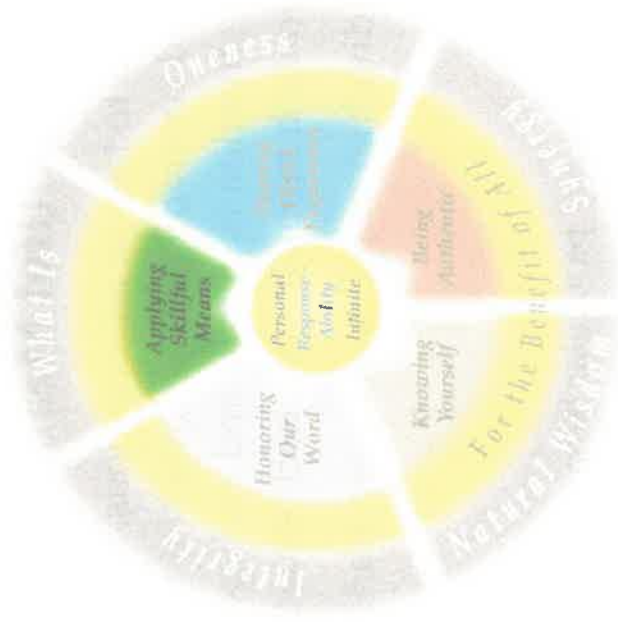
BENEFIT:

Fierce compassion

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Applying Skillful Means

Thinning Our Conditioning

When we are responsible, we depend more on clarity than on conditioning. We are able to move through painful patterns to open space and make decisions that support our vision and mission.

BENEFITS:

Artful seeing
Unlimited options

Love is the only reality and it is not a mere sentiment.

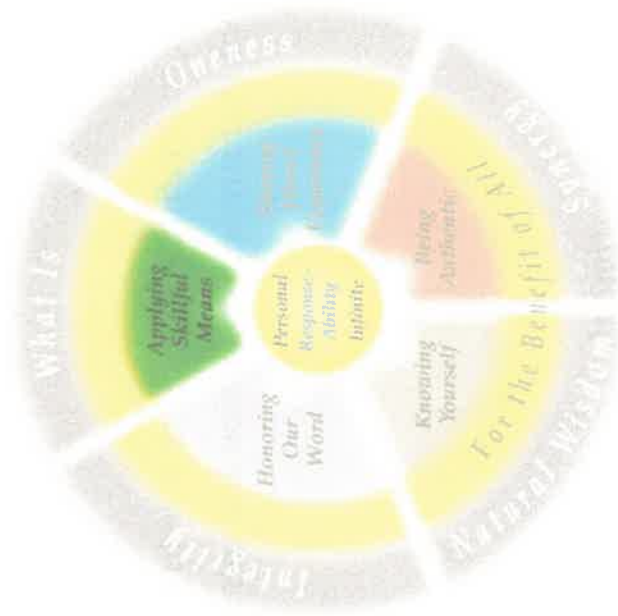
Love is the ultimate truth that lies at the heart of creation.

~ Tagore

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Notes and Reflections



Applying Skillful Means



Opening Our Heart and Mind

Sharing our direct experience in the moment, rather than thoughts, judgments and solutions creates space for transformation. Feedback, when presented side by side with awareness, touches the hearts and minds of those we connect with.

BENEFITS:

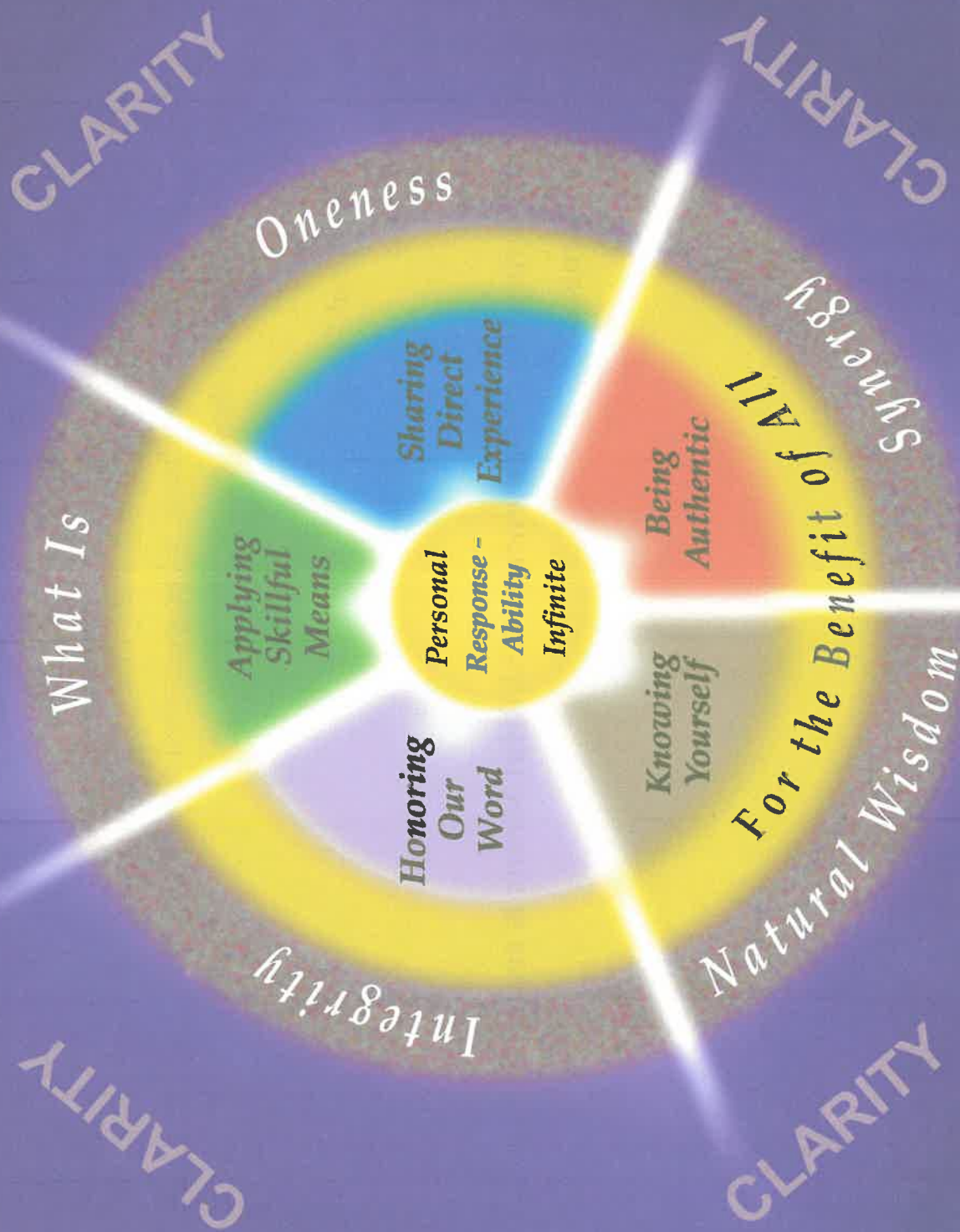
Experiencing the essence of “what is”
Open-hearted authority

The result in mastering the competencies of Skillful Means is seeing each person as capable of wholeness

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Natural Leadership: A Core Competency of Clarity

The result in mastering the competencies of Natural Leadership is
inseparability of clarity and everyday life

Leadership is about creating a domain in which human beings continually deepen their understanding of reality and become more capable of participating in the unfolding of the world. Ultimately, leadership is about creating new realities.

~ Peter M. Senge

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AWAKENED RELATIONSHIPS

A CORE COMPETENCY OF UNCONDITIONAL LOVE

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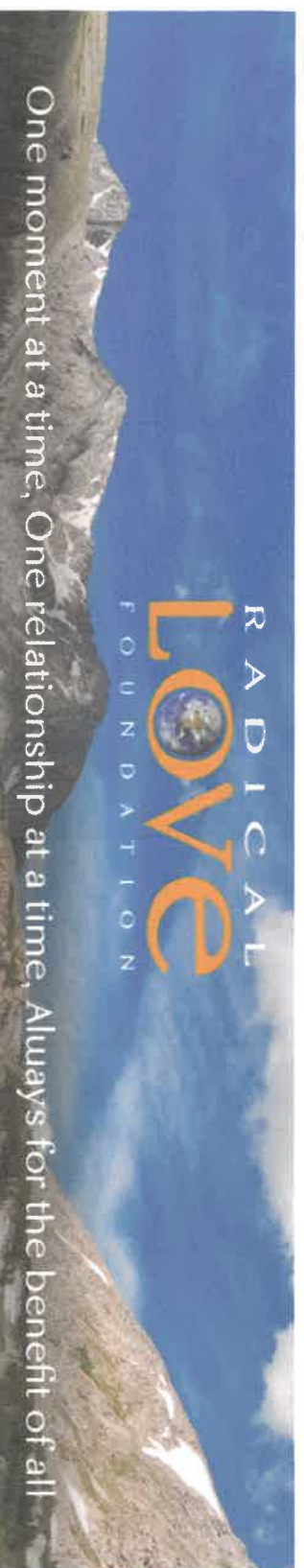
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Purpose, Vision and Mission Statement

Our Purpose: Clarity for the benefit of all.

Our Vision: Living a joyful life free of judgment and fear.

Our Mission: To transform the world through unconditional love and simplicity. We work in partnership and collaboration, providing training through our Awakened Relationships and Natural Leadership programs.

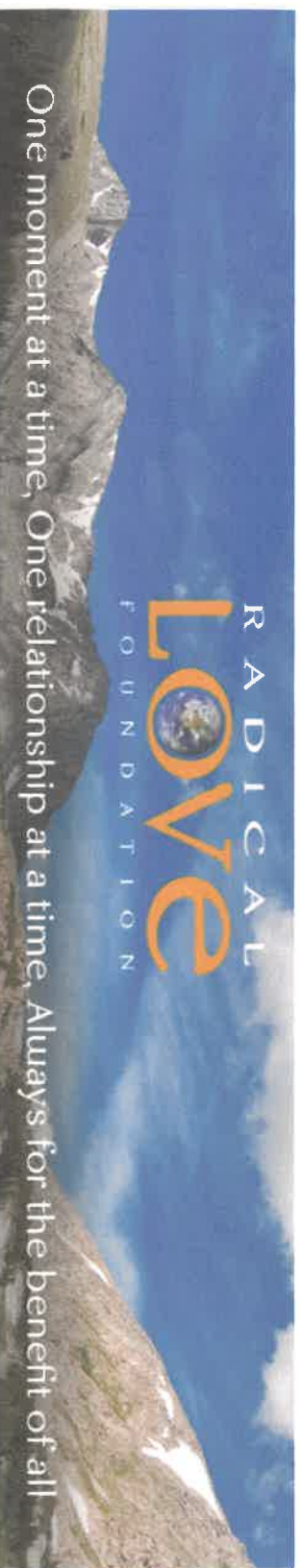
In Radical Love, we share our six Guiding Principles in everyday life, in our organization, on our website, through social media, classes, coaching, special events and a community of like-minded people.

Our culture is transparent and congruent. We live our work. We are committed to sharing clarity with open-hearted kindness and fierce compassion.

Our Guiding Principles are the content of our work.

- Personal Response-Ability
- Sharing Direct Experience
- Knowing Ourselves
- Honoring Our Word
- Being Authentic
- Applying Skillful Means

In Radical Love, each moment is an opportunity to live open-heartedly for the benefit of all.



Love becomes a path of awakening, of rousing us from the sleep and trance states of old unconscious, conditioned patterns into the freshness and immediacy of living more fully. This is the path of Awakened Relationships.

~ Judith Orloff and Melissa Stuart, Co-Founders, Radical Love Foundation

What is an Awakened Relationship?

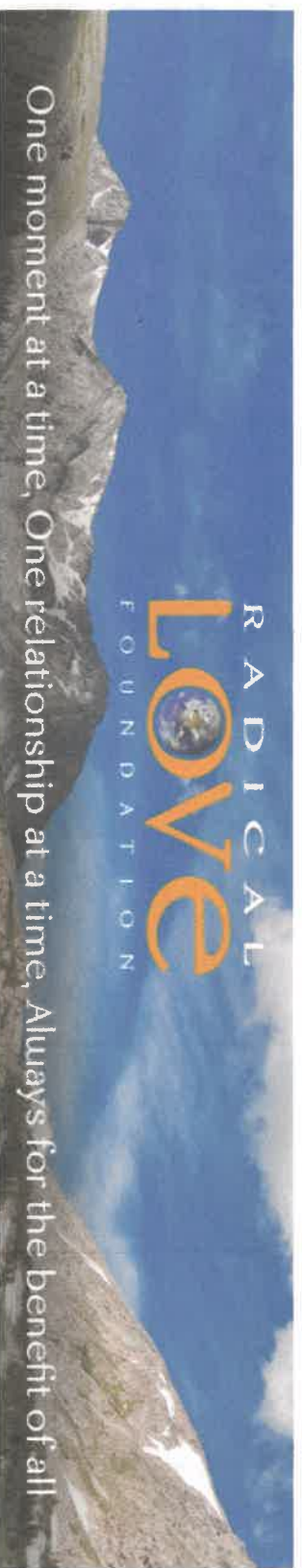
We are both “authentic” and “awake,” yet the space between being awake and being authentic is vast. Authentic means genuine, of undisputed origin, accurate and reliable. Awake means to be aware of something for the first time, to become conscious, to stop sleeping, to realize, and be mindful.

An authentic relationship is when we can depend on someone to be who we know them to be. We are not surprised at their response to what comes their way. We are not even surprised by what comes our way. We can feel comfort knowing how each of us will respond to being interrupted, making a mistake, the sensation of touch, religion, politics and new perspectives.

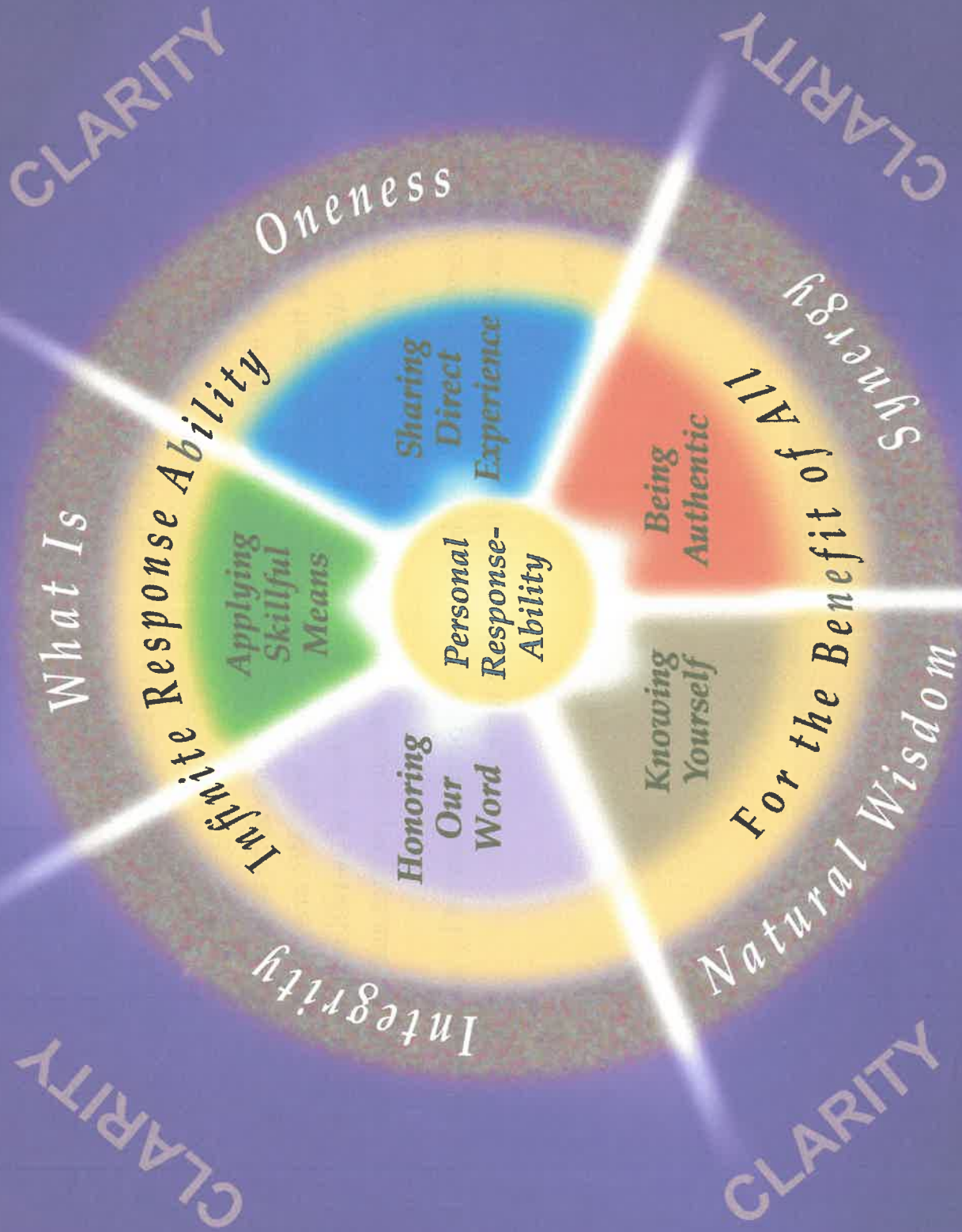
An awakened relationship can and does bring many surprises moment by moment. We cannot know what is next, as we are seeing “as if for the first time.”

Both authentic and awake exist simultaneously.

Why not experience both?

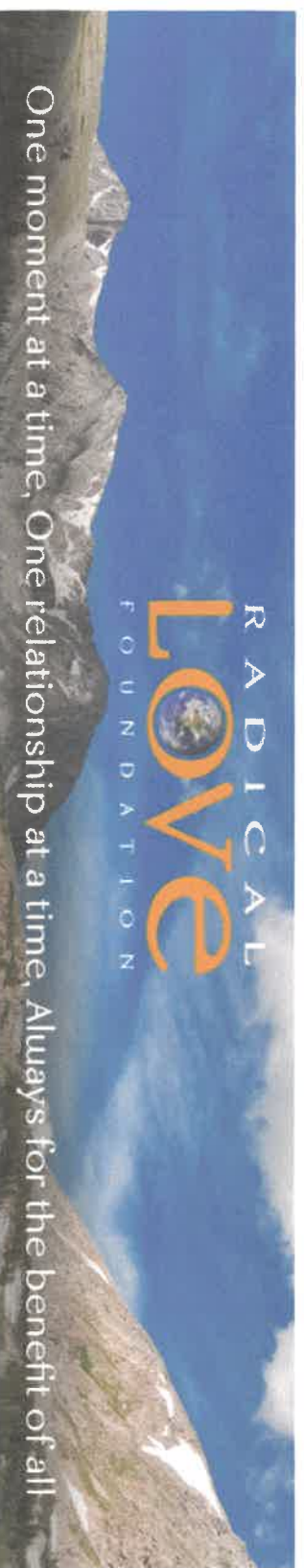


AWAKENED RELATIONSHIPS: A CORE COMPETENCY OF UNCONDITIONAL LOVE

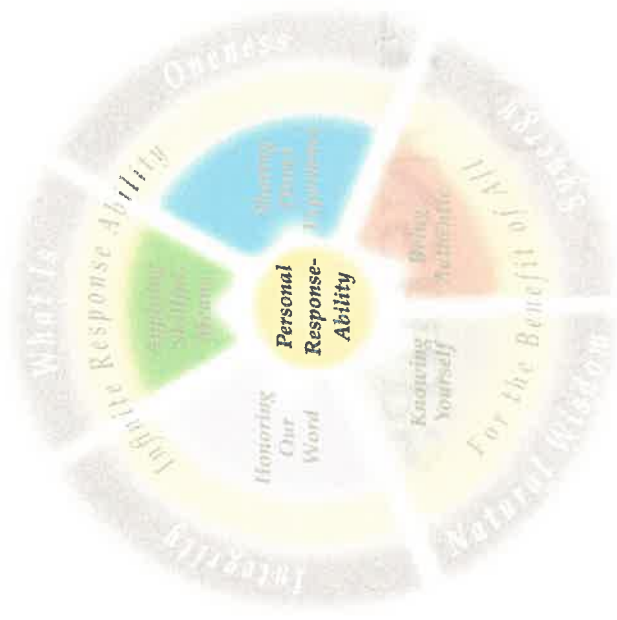


AWAKENED RELATIONSHIPS

A CORE COMPETENCY OF UNCONDITIONAL LOVE



Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #1 – Personal Response-Ability

Being personally responsible (response-able) means mastering the ability to respond to each situation, each moment, with unlimited options, always for the benefit of all.

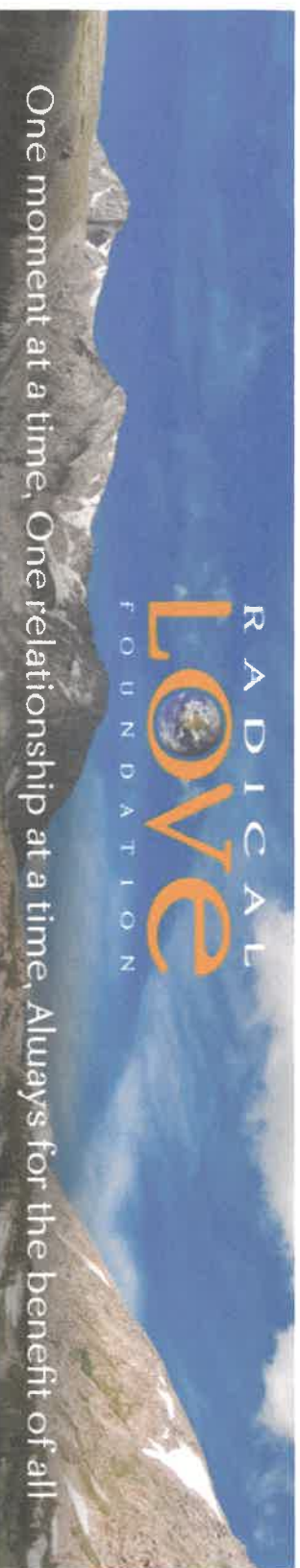
We Are Our Results: We Are Response-Able

We are not separate from our results.

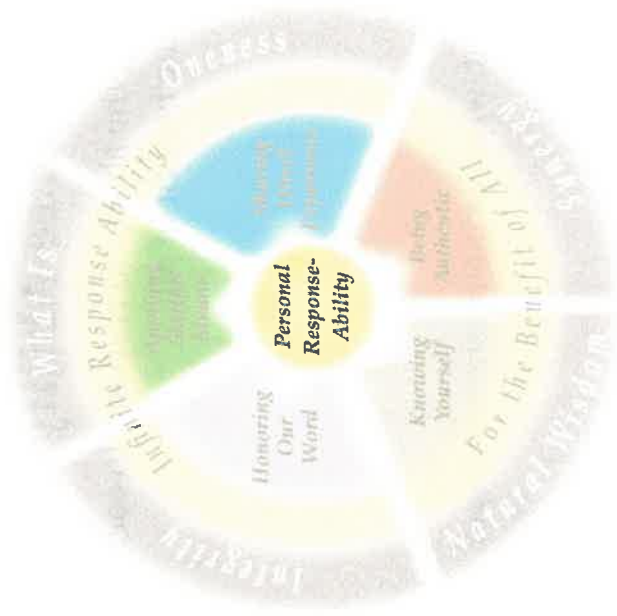
- We are already awake
- Reality = “What is”
- Being in the present moment gives us nothing to think about, whereas interpretations flavor and color our experience
- Our responses are unique and reflect our conditioning
- Options are unlimited
- Actions are for the benefit of all

Benefits

- Gratitude
- We experience the world as we experience ourselves
- Contributing fully
- Open-hearted behavior



Notes and Reflections



Personal Response-Ability

Seeing Possibilities: All Points of View Arise and Resolve in Clarity

When we live in a world of right and wrong, or good and bad, our life will continue just as it is now.

See all points of view as equal. Experiencing all points of view enlivens us.

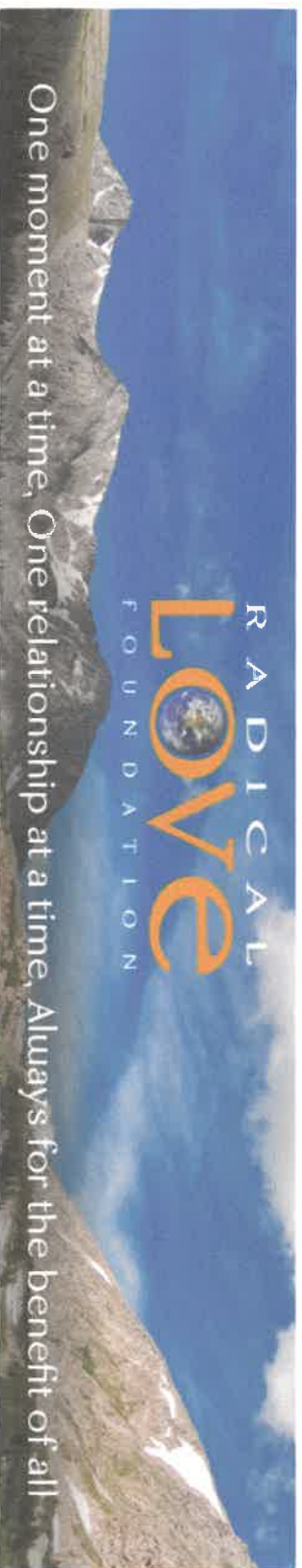
- All that we see is our point of view
- All points of view are equal as they originate from clarity
- Sharing our points of view gives access to clarity

Benefits

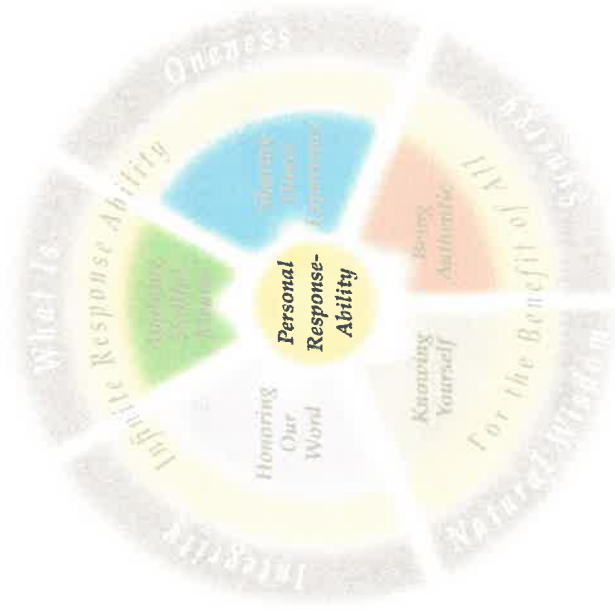
- Each moment is an opportunity for discovery of ourselves and the world around us
- Intimacy with oneness

When we forget our vision, it is easy to believe our fears are true.

~ Radical Love Fieldbook



Notes and Reflections



Personal Response-Ability

Transparency and Harmony: No Separation

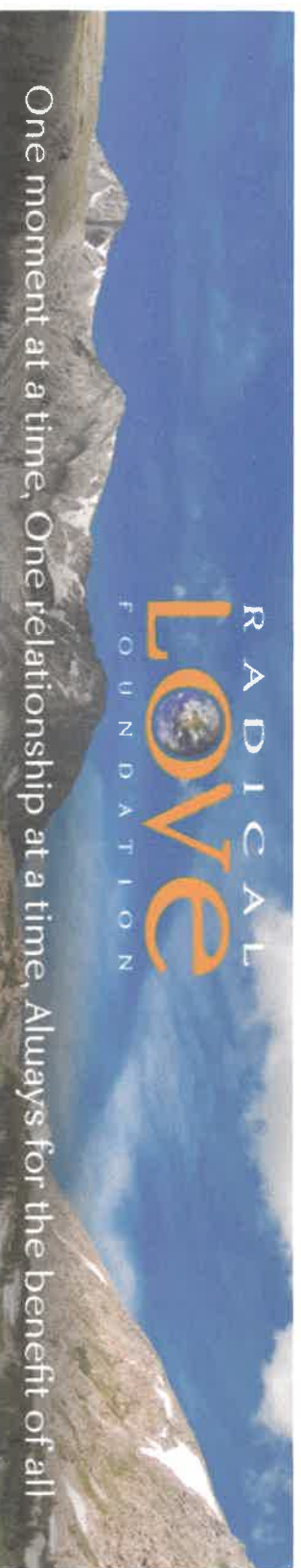
When our feelings, expression and behavior match, we are congruent.

- When congruent, there is no separation between ourselves and others
- We naturally share what is arising in the moment
- We feel everything and do not conform to pretense

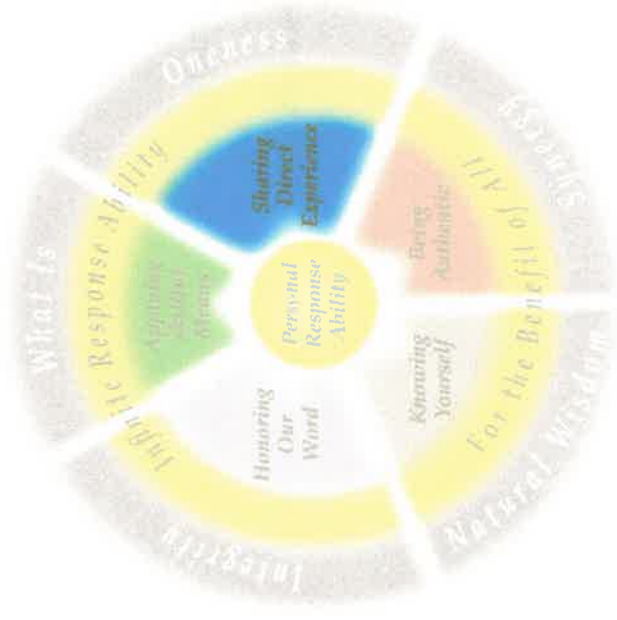
Benefits

- Vitality
- Natural seeing of "What is"
- Unimpaired sensory perception

The result in mastering the competency of
Personal Response-Ability is trust in life itself.



Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #2 – Sharing Direct Experience

Language constructs the details of experience. Honesty, plus intimacy, about our experience, informed by clarity, is what allows for transformation. Giving and receiving feedback with “good purpose” means sharing your direct experience with nothing added or withheld. This is a direct path into clarity and connection.

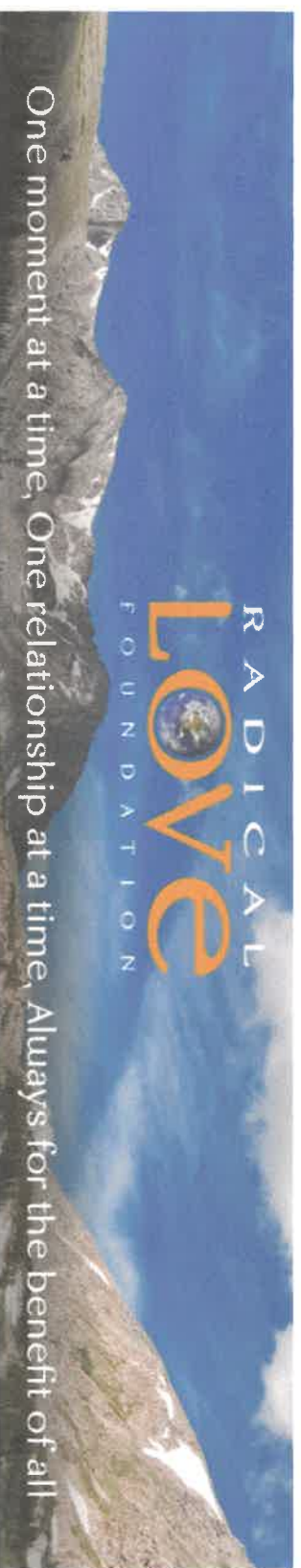
Listening and Receiving: Our Body is the Receiver of Our Experience

Our bodies are the receiver of our experience; our minds are the deceiver. With radical listening you receive the history and potential futures of the communication.

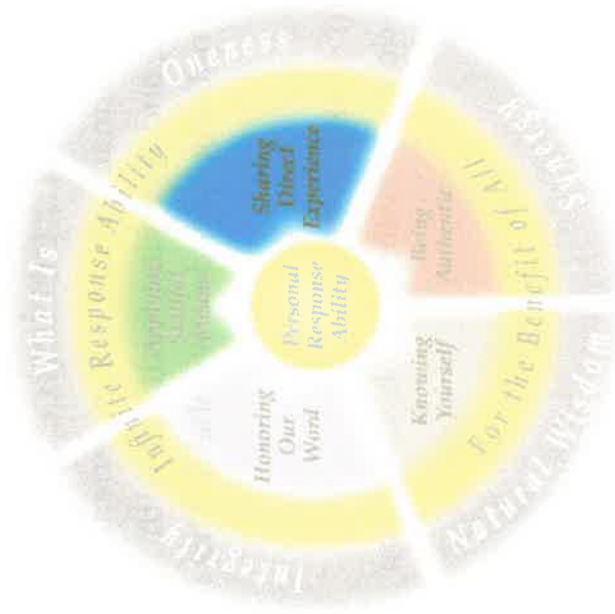
- Be informed and guided by the sensations in your body
- There is no experience without sensation
- Feelings are sensations
- Be willing to feel your feelings
- Feelings not experienced persist and control us
- Feelings can dissolve conditioning

Benefits

- Freedom from reactivity
- Spontaneity
- Sensing and feeling the whole
- Equanimity



Notes and Reflections



Sharing Direct Experience

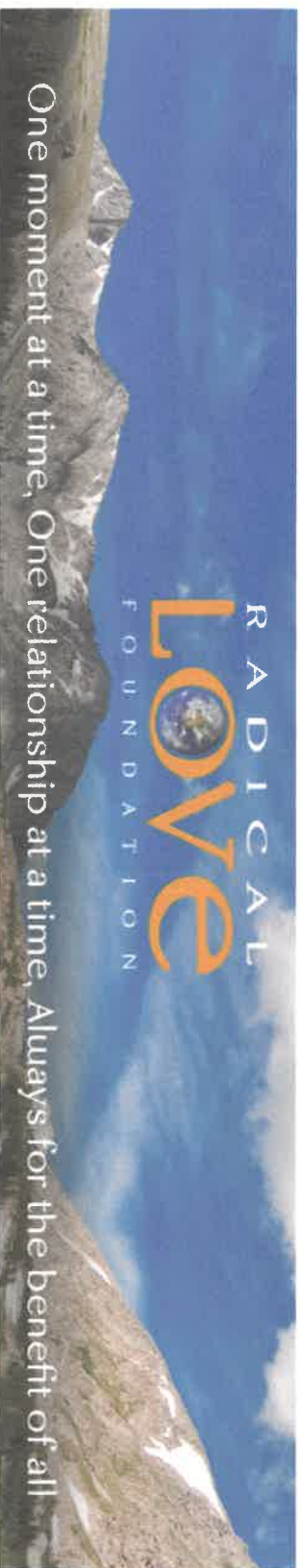
Opportunity for Transformation: Direct Experience

The moment we choose a new behavior and a new interpretation, our conditioning evolves. Those around us usually do not respond in the same way.

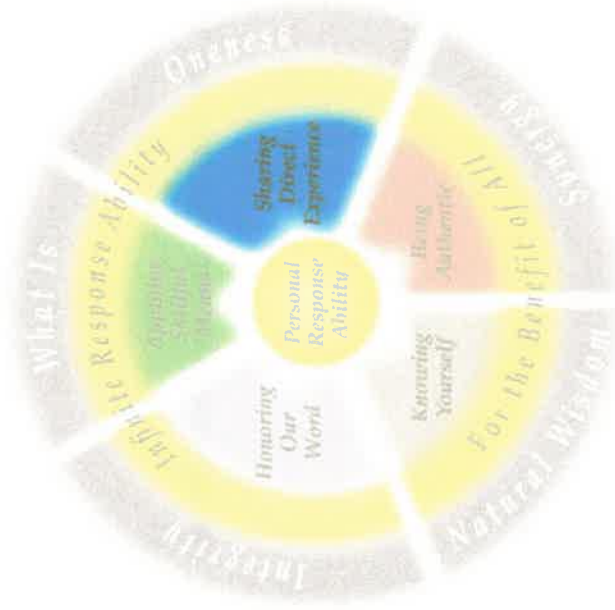
- “What is” right here, right now
- There is no effort involved, it's effortless
- When we share about ourselves, there is nothing to argue with

Benefits

- Clarity
- Originality
- Simplicity
- Listening and speaking for the benefit of all



Notes and Reflections



*All relationships are the mirrors for us to face and understand ourselves
more rapidly and profoundly than any other aspect of worldly life.*

Radical Intimacy paves the way to Awakened Relationships.

~ Radical Love Fieldbook

Sharing Direct Experience

Without Reason: Radical Intimacy

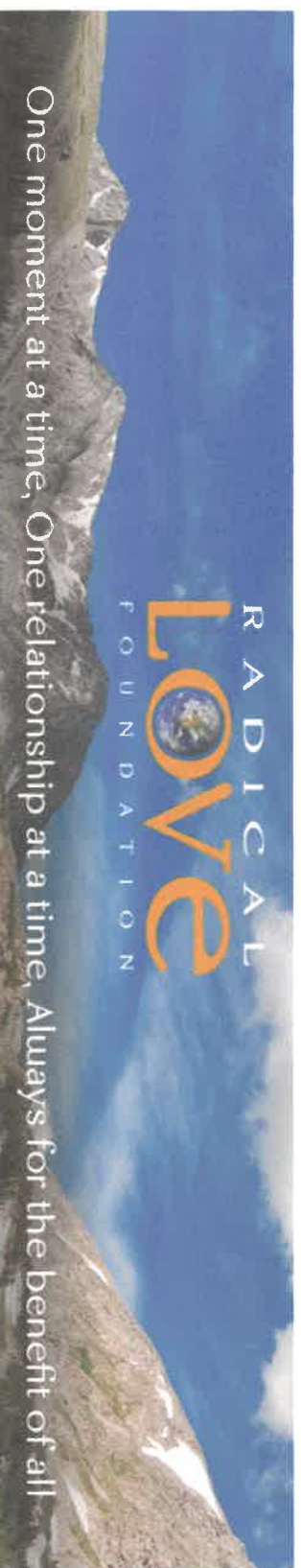
When we defend, justify or explain, we believe we are convincing someone (including ourselves) of the truth of our perspective.

- Sharing direct experience
- Seeing and feeling deeply

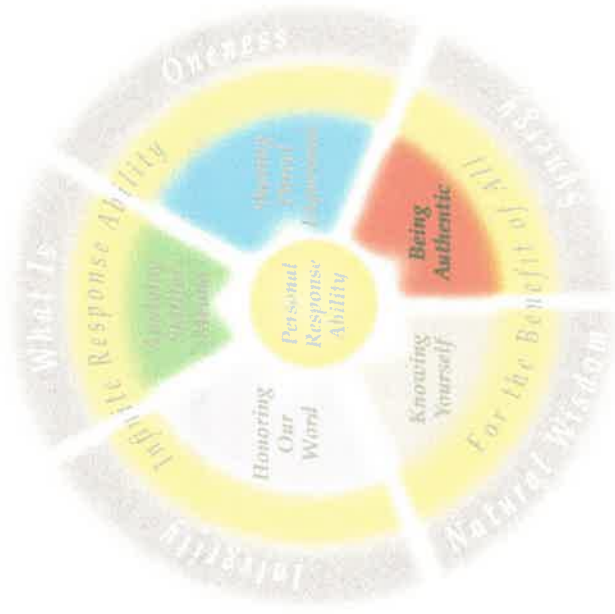
Benefits

- Natural connection
- Open-hearted relationships
- Speaking the unspeakable
- Freedom to share our inherent talents and gifts

The result of mastering the competency of
Sharing Direct Experience is oneness.



Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #3 – Being Authentic

Authenticity is undisputed credibility and genuineness. We view ourselves and others as unique and equal.

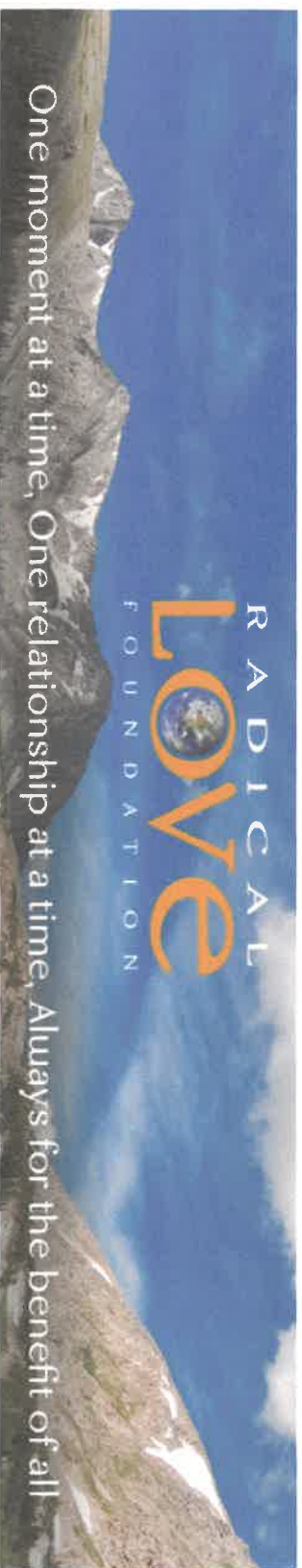
Communicating without Pretense: Fierce Compassion

We are already open. Being this openness is all that is required. Our actions arise from clarity.

- Seeing through reactive states
- Sharing the simple truth of our direct experience
- Allowing clarity to inform our behavior
- Standing our ground

Benefits

- Widening the river of experience
- Deep understanding
- Peace



Notes and Reflections



Being Authentic

Trust and Equality: Living in Partnership

We are equal in creating our partnerships. Our interpretation of circumstance is conditioned. Put your trust in clarity and enjoy the benefit of having nothing to think about.

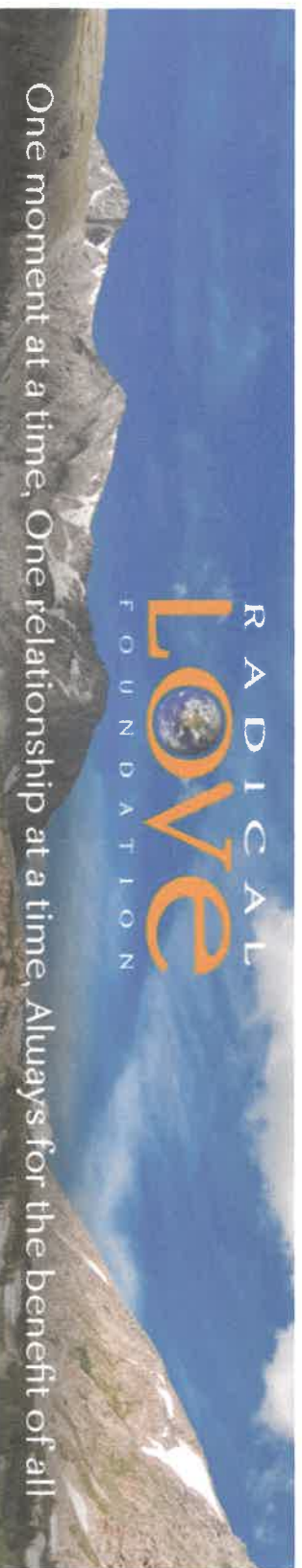
- Turning towards the other
- Giving what you are asking for
- Receiving the whole of communication
- Mutually sharing direct experience

Benefits

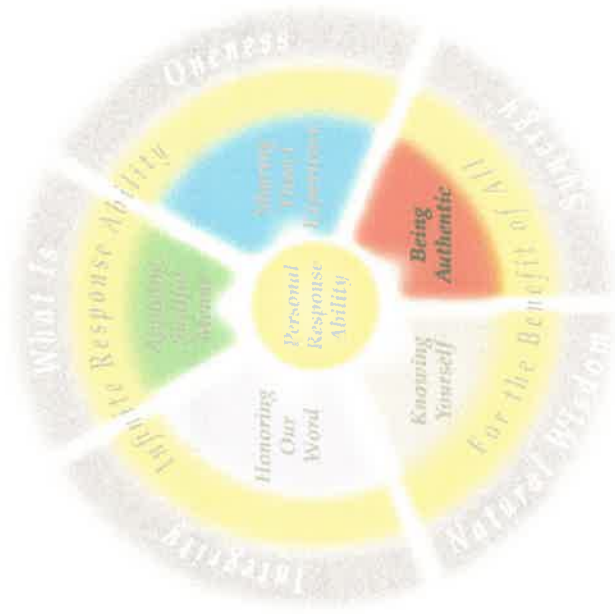
- Friendship
- Collaboration and support
- Generosity

Be willing to be with each other right here, right now, without agenda, precondition, or attachment to an outcome. It becomes more important to stay present, than it does to have your way.

~ Melissa Stuart, Co-Founder, Radical Love Foundation



Notes and Reflections



Being Authentic

Our True Nature is Always for the Benefit of All: Interdependence

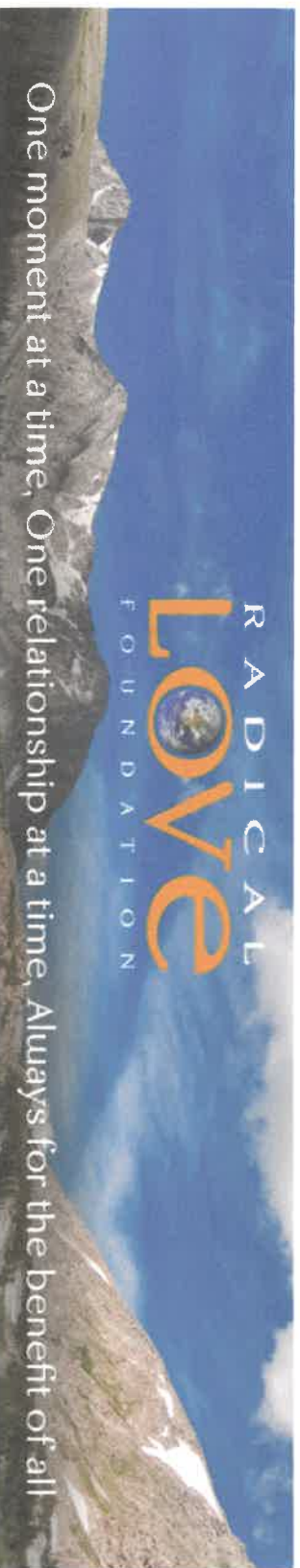
When clarity informs our behavior there are no sides. There is natural balance. We are interdependent. Effort and struggle dissolves.

- Sharing of direct experience
- Responding to the true needs of others
- We are responsible for our collective evolution

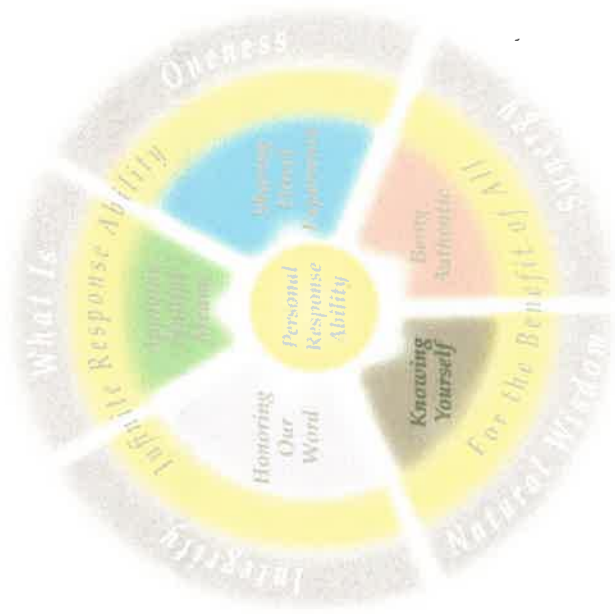
Benefits

- Relationships are informed by clarity
- Awareness of the consequences of our actions locally and globally
- Infinite responsibility

**The result in mastering the competency of
Being Authentic is freedom.**



Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #4 – Knowing Yourself

Knowing our self and our points of view allows us to walk in the world without fear of loss and the need to control our environment.

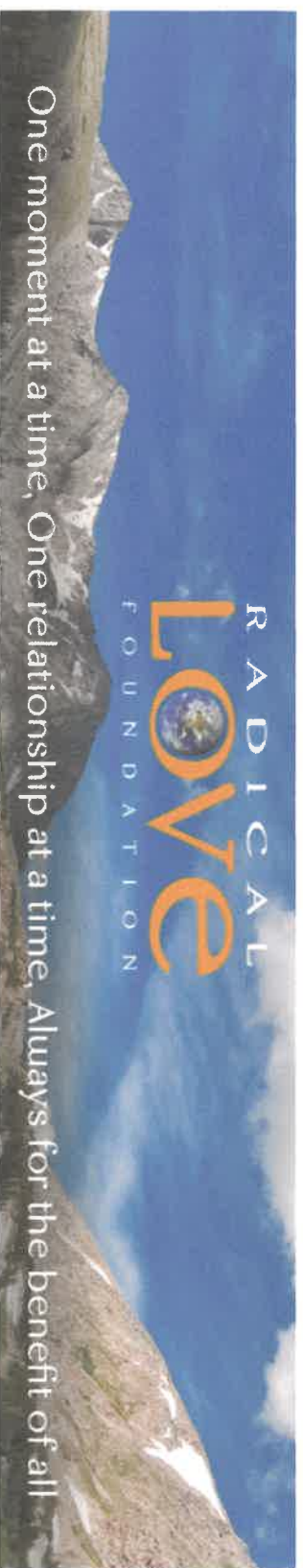
Understanding Our True Nature: Being Human

Although we can only point to that “Which is,” our relationship with clarity guides us to our true nature. Our true nature is only and always for the benefit of all.

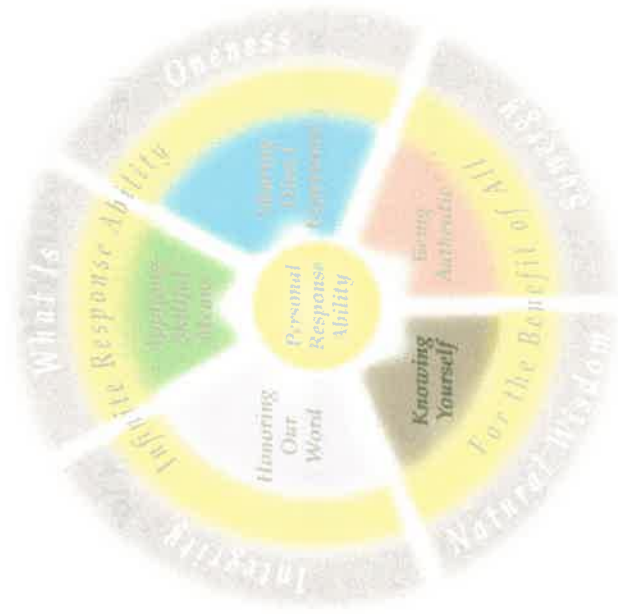
- We are all unique in our expression, while the same in our humanity
- We are equal in our emotional capability
- We are all equally conditioned, yet not conditioned equally
- We are life

Benefits

- Authentic self-expression
- Fearlessness in relationship
- Appreciation of our human nature
- Our attitude toward life itself is open and clear



Notes and Reflections



Knowing Yourself

Assuming Innocence: Seeing through Conditioning

Even if another person is behaving in a hurtful manner, it is not personal to us. It is how they were taught to express themselves. How we respond is how we were taught to express ourselves.

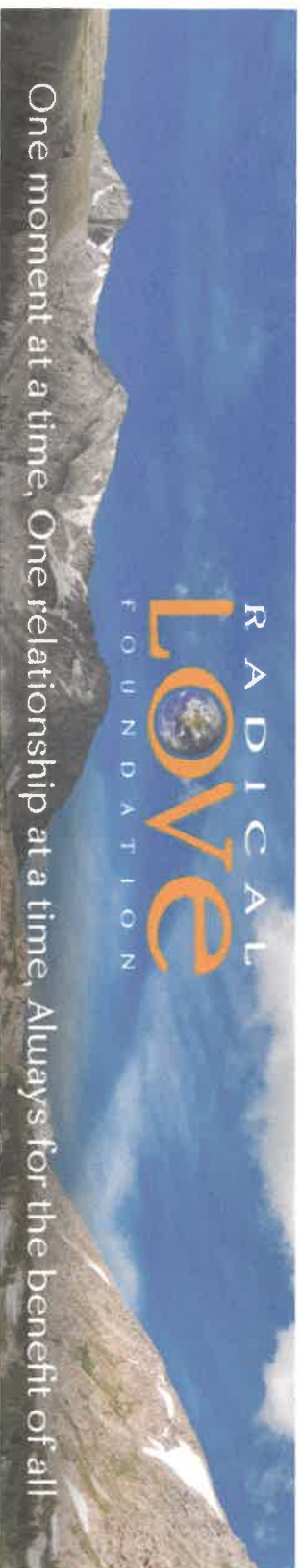
- Our conditioned patterns are rooted in our family history and our culture
- When we are informed by clarity, our patterns dissolve
- Having the full experience of our feelings evolves our conditioning
- As our conditioning evolves, so do our morals and ethics

Benefits

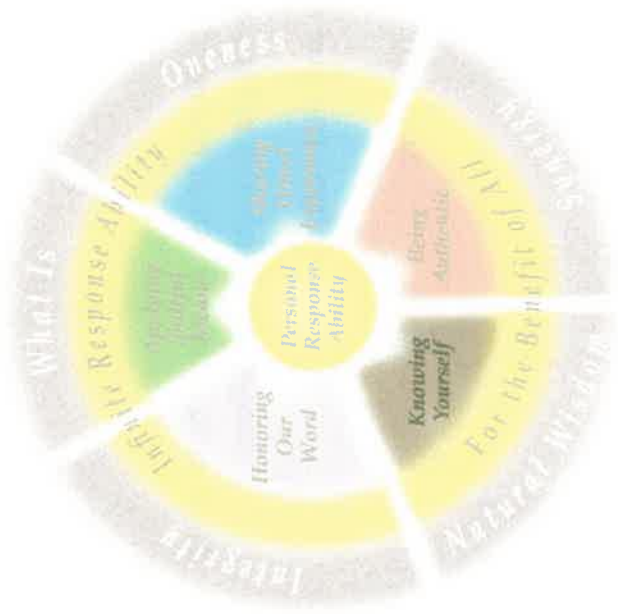
- Living joyfully
- Open-hearted compassion
- Closeness and intimacy in everyday life

In the midst of uncertainty, we can know truth.

~ Judith Orloff



Notes and Reflections



Knowing Yourself

Living Our Life Purpose: Wellbeing

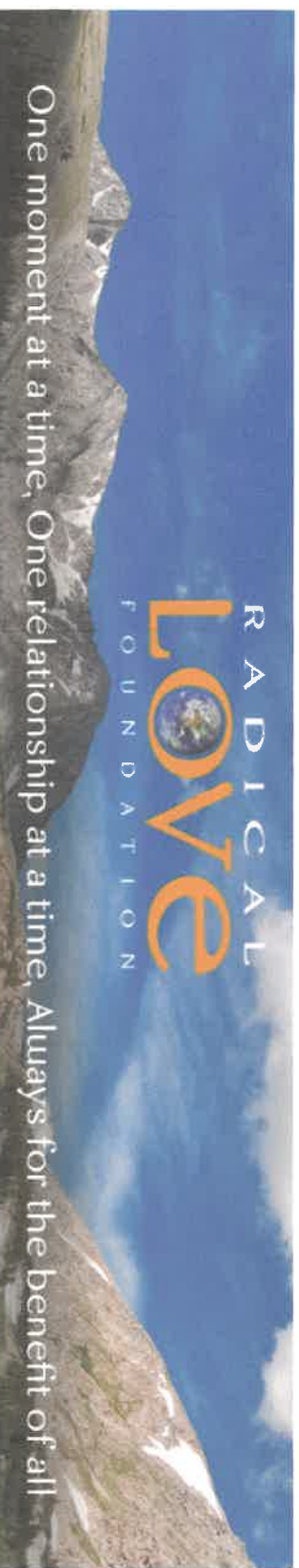
Using our natural gifts and talents, for the benefit of all.

- When we're caring for ourselves, we're caring for everyone
- Experience everyone as they are, without interpretation
- Use skillful means in all situations

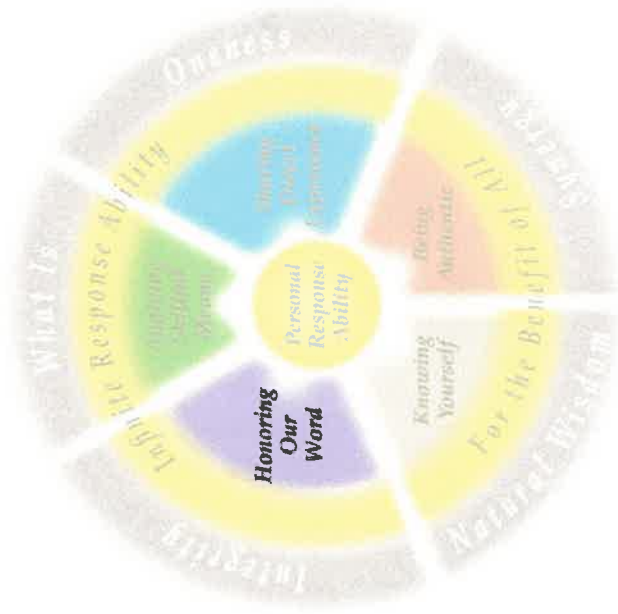
Benefits

- Healthy, authentic living
- Natural curiosity
- Living a beneficial life

**The result in mastering the competency of
Knowing Yourself is natural wisdom,
natural authority and natural ethics.**



Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #5 – Honoring Our Word

Honor and keep our word.

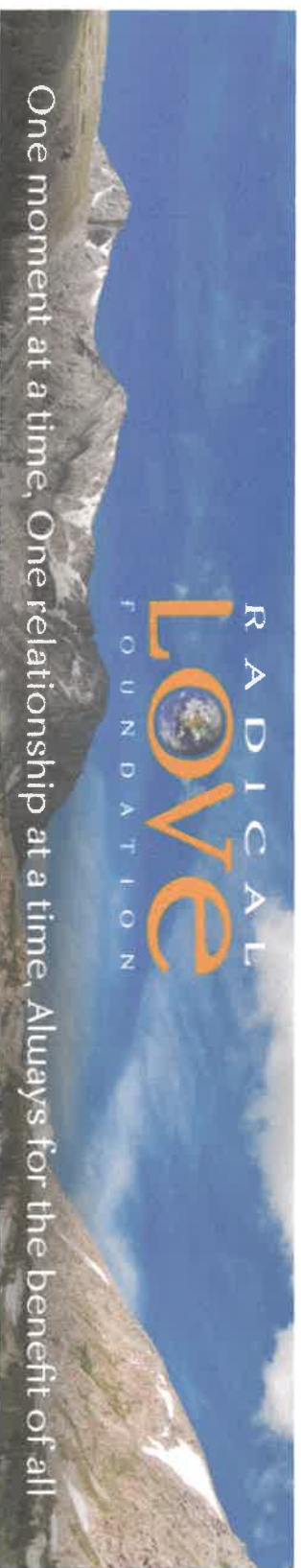
Keeping Our Word: Integrity-based Relationship

Keeping our word is radical integrity.

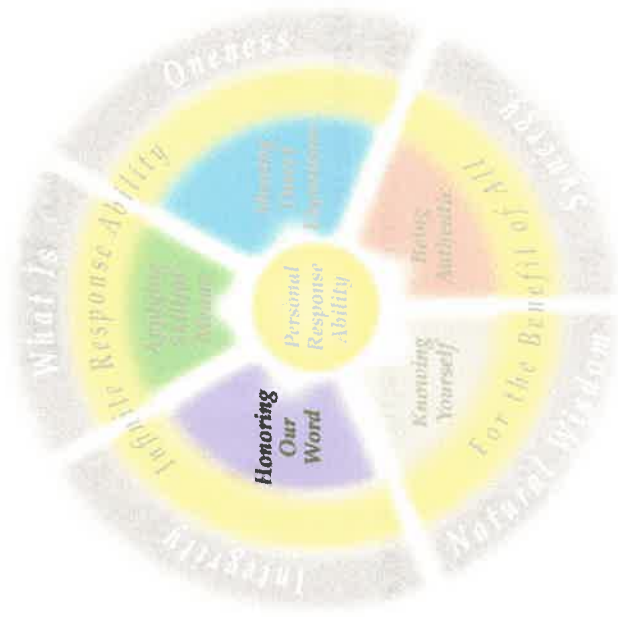
- Keeping our word is simply doing what we say, no matter how we feel
- If we are unable to keep our word, we honor our word by communicating any change as soon as possible and making sure the other people are whole
- Our natural confidence is strengthened by keeping our word

Benefits

- Integrity
- Flexibility
- Clear mind
- Being complete and whole



Notes and Reflections



Honoring Our Word

Communication in Relationship: Everyday Clarity

We are already in relationship with everyone we meet. We are free to respond for the benefit of all.

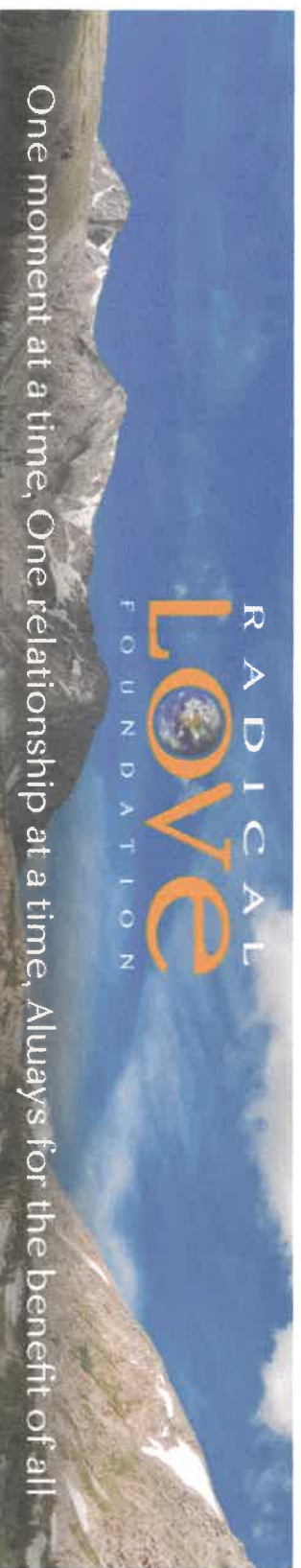
- Seeing the natural flow of all points of view and perspectives
- Allowing things to be as they are
- Assumptions and reasons dissolve upon inquiry
- One step at a time

Benefits

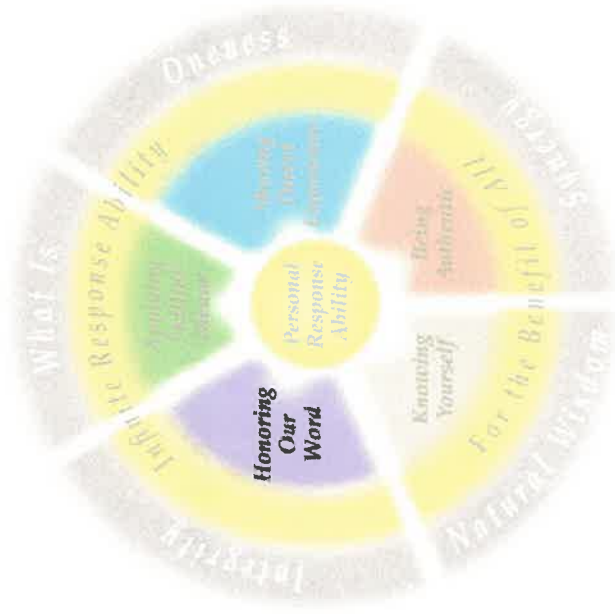
- Self-respect
- Natural wisdom
- Common sense

You maximize the opportunity for success if you honor your word. Honoring your word is privately optimal in the sense that it requires no cooperation from anyone else. Even if everyone else is out of integrity, it is in your best interest to be a man or woman of integrity.

~ Werner Erhard



Notes and Reflections



Honoring Our Word

Free Choice: The Good of the Whole

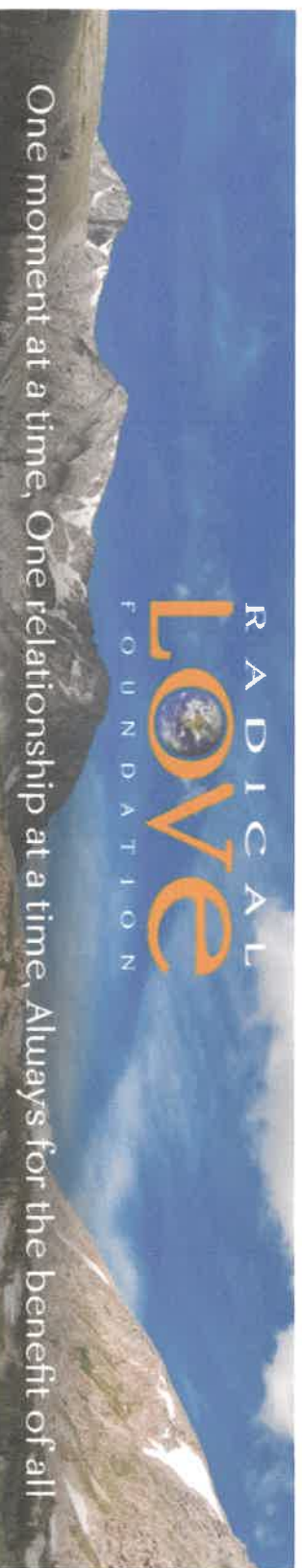
When we make a free choice, it includes the consideration of all points of view, is made without conditions, and is for the good of the whole.

- Consider all options
- Experience all points of view
- No perspective is independent
- All points of view arise in clarity, for the benefit of all

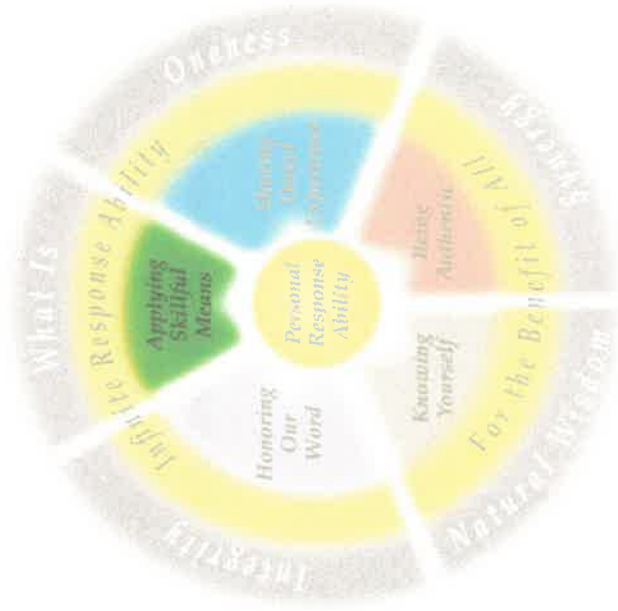
Benefits

- Natural morals and ethics
- Being authentic in relationship
- Radical humility

The result in mastering the competency of
Honoring Our Word is peace of mind.



Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #6 – Applying Skillful Means

Skillful Means allow us to know what actions to take in all situations. Skillful Means point to truth, and are extremely flexible and contradictory. Each moment, situation and person is unique. Only when relying on clarity can we use Skillful Means. Clarity points us to what makes sense in each moment with each situation.

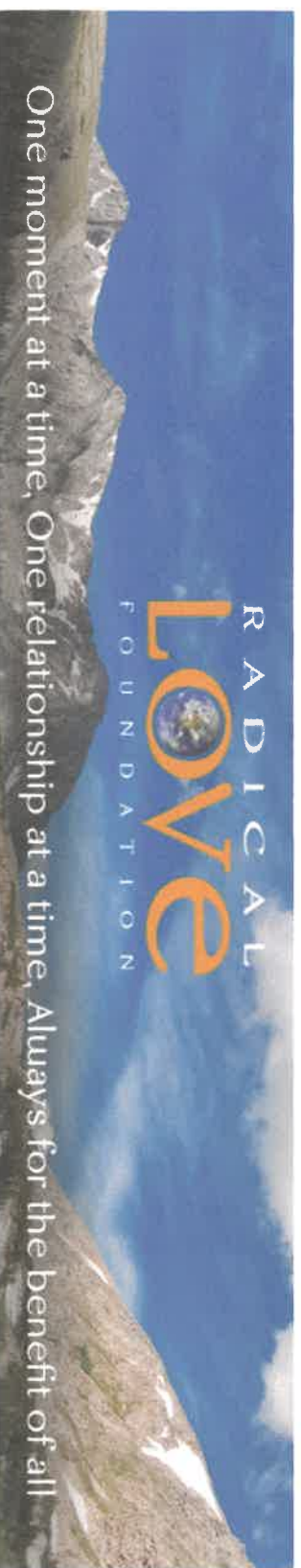
Opening Our Heart and Mind: Being Vulnerable

The safety of vulnerability gives us the courage to open our heart and mind. Being vulnerable is the gateway to freedom.

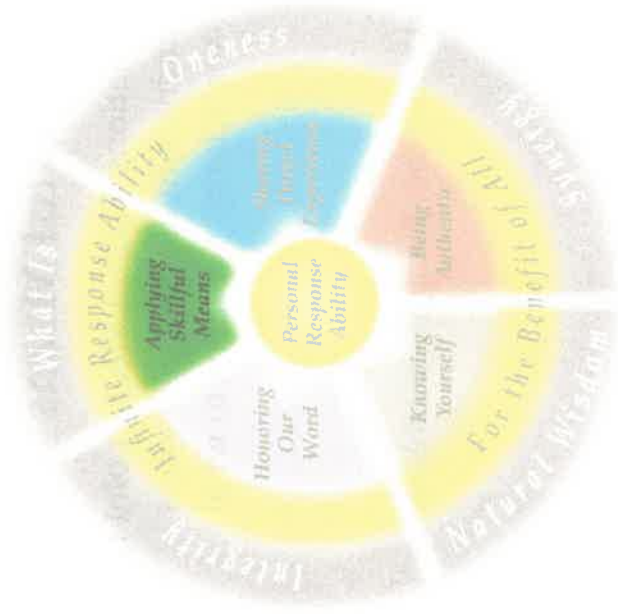
- Having the courage to be seen and known by others
- Vulnerability in all situations is our greatest strength
- Experience all sensations and feelings

Benefits

- Living joyfully
- Fulfillment
- Unlimited access to creativity
- Endless unfolding of our innate intelligence



Notes and Reflections



Applying Skillful Means

Seeing through Our Reactions: Reactions are Goldmines

Reactions are the cultural adaptation to our true feelings. Reactions were a creative survival strategy when we were children. Reactions in the present moment are illusions that we believe are true. Fully feeling our feelings lifts the veil of illusion, freeing us to respond.

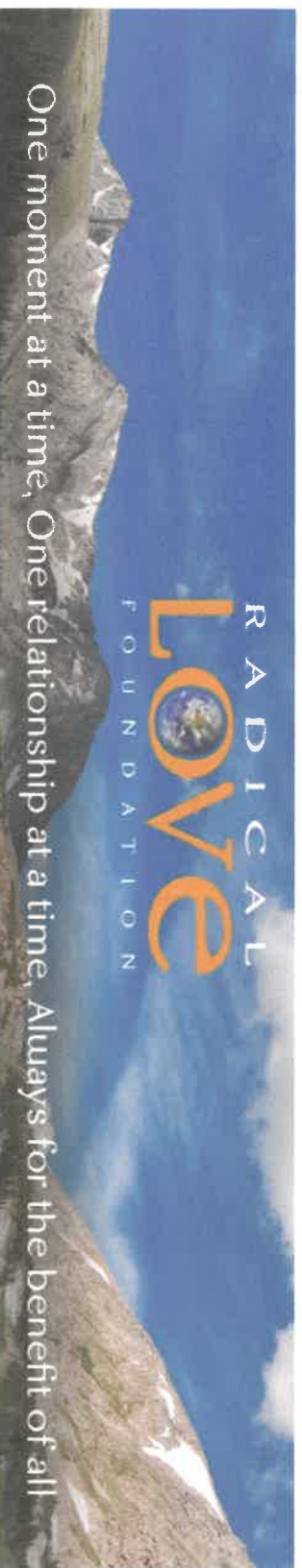
- Reactions are goldmines – feelings are the gold
- Reactions cover our deepest hurts and fears
- In reaction we are victims to circumstance
- When we experience our hurts and fears our reactions disappear
- Sharing our direct experience provides simple access to our true nature

Benefits

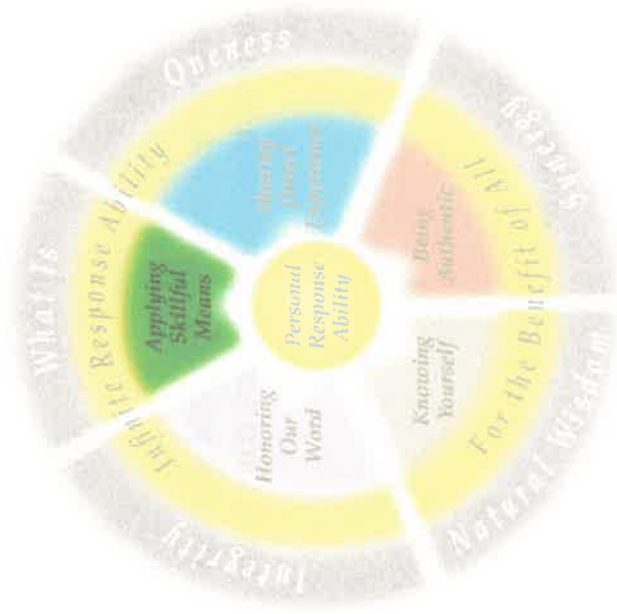
- Thinning our habitual conditioning
- Eliminating the reactive perspective of “either/or”
- Being in wonder and natural wisdom

*Using Skillful Means profoundly connects the core of our being with another,
and directly recognizes oneness in relationship.*

~ Radical Love Fieldbook



Notes and Reflections



Applying Skillful Means

Thinning Our Conditioning: Expressing Our Humanity

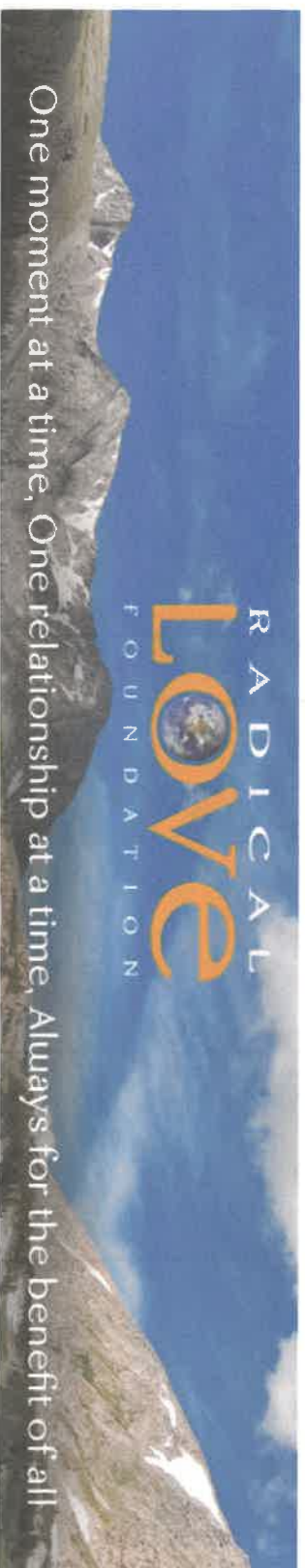
There is nothing in our past that cannot be dissolved. There is no behavior that cannot be transformed, no behavior that cannot be changed. We just have to want this change more than we desire comfort, no matter how uncomfortable we feel.

- We are only "one"
- Whatever we see is "us"
- Whatever we give and receive is "us"
- Be with "What is" rather than attempting to change anyone or anything
- Experience the wholeness of giving and receiving, always for the benefit of all

Benefits

- Seeing the obvious
- Unity

The result in mastering the competency of
Skillful Means is knowing each person is whole.



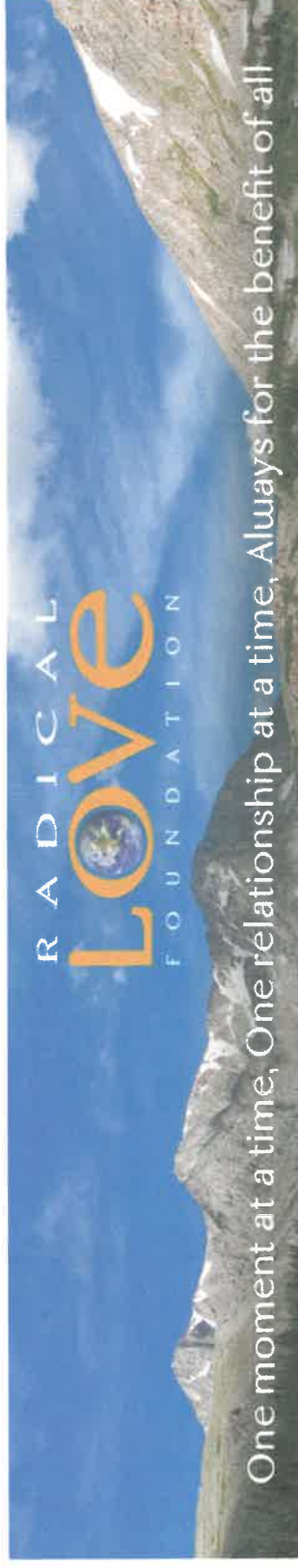
Awakened Relationships: A Core Competency of Unconditional Love

For the Benefit of All

Our individual capacity to love and be kind to ourselves is fundamental to our sense of joy, happiness and wellbeing. Because we are not ultimately separate, our direct experience tells us that we cannot love ourselves, unless everyone we touch experiences benefit in their interaction with us. “For the benefit of all” directs our evolution and maturation as an individual and a species.

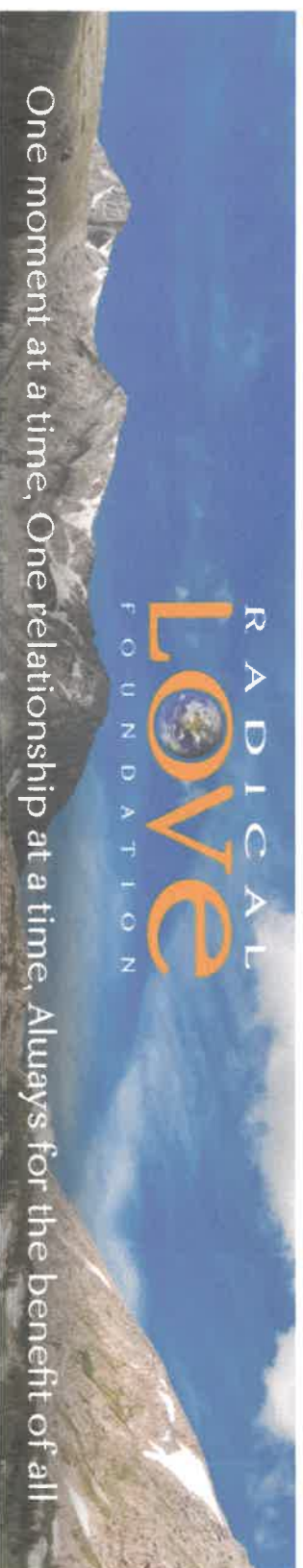
Infinite Responsibility

Infinite Responsibility is response-ability without boundaries or limitations. As an individual I am personally response-able each moment of my life. As unique life itself, that which I think, feel, believe and offer to the world is my infinite responsibility towards the next moment that nothing else can equal.



For the Benefit of All unites us with all living beings.

~ Judith Orloff and Melissa Stuart,
Co-Founders, Radical Love Foundation



One moment at a time, One relationship at a time, Always for the benefit of all

